PROGRESS REPORT

Africa: progress report, October 2025 – October 2026

Edition of 2026-10-12 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

> *Compiled 2026-10-12 by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository. Sections run from the region's institutions outwards to what funds them. Each row sets the position at the start of the period against the position at the end, and the Progress column says how it moved. The period runs to the date of issue rather than to the last month's close.*

SUMMARY OF THE PERIOD · INSTITUTIONS AND MANDATES · INSTRUMENTS AND HARMONISATION · SHARED SYSTEMS AND INFRASTRUCTURE · COORDINATION AND COLLABORATION · CAPACITY AND INCLUSION · FINANCE · WHERE THE RECORD IS THIN

Of 234 bodies, instruments and systems on this place's ledger, 138 changed position between 2025-10-01 and 2026-10-12, 30 did not, 63 carry no stated baseline, and 3 are **Not held** *at both ends.*

Shape check, run before the comparison: 1106 sources for this place in the window — 173 in the earlier half (2025-10 to 2026-03), 933 in the later (2026-04 to 2026-10). The earlier half of the window is thin: this is a shorter comparison wearing a longer label, and the movement below rests mostly on the later half.

Progress values. *Movement* — some form of progress, however minor, has been recorded. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a reported position worsened. *Closed* — the programme ended. *No change* — the repository holds a standing position and nothing in the period touched it. *Baseline not held* — there is evidence of movement but no baseline to compare it against. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Movement, slipped*.

Summary of the period

The year's continental movement was institutional rather than operational. Bodies were constituted, positions adopted and memoranda signed across artificial intelligence, connectivity and payments, and very little of it yet carries a delivery figure. The Africa AI Council was established, an Algiers declaration on telecommunications sovereignty was adopted, a continental payments rail passed 190 institutions in 28 countries, and the digital trade protocol still has no ratification count. Where numbers exist they are mostly one side's own: an operator's ranking, a company's training pledge, a foundation's cohort call.

One fact runs underneath the rest. Official development assistance fell sharply in 2025 with a further fall expected, and the agency that said so told its board its model is shifting from delivering aid to mobilising investment — which bears on almost every programme here without naming one.

Institutions and mandates

Regional collaboration

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-10-01	AT 2026-10-12	PROGRESS
AfCFTA Digital Trade Corridor	Did not exist	a joint venture agreement signed in Accra on 31 August 2026 between the AfCFTA Secretariat and a Ghanaian technology company to build a corridor facilitating, tracking and settling cross-border trade transactions in compliance with continental trade rules and reducing reliance on routing payments through third countries	MOVEMENT
AfCFTA Protocol on Digital Trade	State parties committed to expedite ratification and domestication under eight calls to action; no ratification count is published with them; the calls carry no enforcement mechanism, no ratification deadline and no named financing	Eight annexes to the protocol were approved in February 2025 and the intellectual-property annexes adopted in February 2026, and all of them still await national ratification and incorporation; the July 2026 calls to action to expedite ratification carry no enforcement mechanism, no deadline and no named financing, and no ratification count is published	MOVEMENT unratified
AfCFTA Secretariat	Council bureau chaired by Egypt; the digital trade protocol adopted but no forum convened on it	Nigeria in the chair with digital trade among four stated priorities, a second digital trade forum held and a data-exchange system of the Secretariat's own launched	MOVEMENT
Africa Internet Governance Forum	The fourteenth annual forum held in Dar es Salaam on 29-31 May 2025 with 1,097 participants from 67 countries, adopting the Dar es Salaam Declaration and Action Plan (2025-05)	The fifteenth annual forum is scheduled for the Labadi Beach Hotel, Accra, from 2 to 5 November 2026, running a main forum alongside youth, parliamentarian and Day Zero tracks and the African School on Internet Governance. The UN Economic Commission for Africa opened a continental call on 18 September 2026 for African AI-enabled solutions to be shown at an ECA Innovation Cafe at the forum, run through the Africa IGF Secretariat with the ITU and Research ICT Africa; session times, venues and speakers were not published when the schedule was read	MOVEMENT marginal
Africa Prosperity Dialogues 2027	Did not exist	A fifth edition of a continental forum scheduled for 27 to 29 January 2027 in Accra, themed on free movement, seamless payment and increased trade, with registration opening 7 September 2026. At its launch a continental development agency's director of infrastructure, industrialisation, trade and regional integration said political declarations alone were no longer enough and that free movement, integrated infrastructure and a single market will fail without harmonised regulations, technical standards and legal systems	MOVEMENT
African Financial Stability Committee	Set up by the central banks' Assembly of Governors on 4 September 2024, renamed from the African Financial Stability Board Egypt had proposed, with terms of reference adopted and Egypt to host its first meeting and chair its Financial Stability Report working group (2024-09)	Hosted by the Association of African Central Banks and running a Macroprudential Policy Development and Implementation Working Group and an African Financial Stability Report Working Group; the continental portal carrying its mandate, structure, member central banks, meeting calendar and working groups was built and launched by the Central Bank of Egypt rather than by the association's secretariat, executing a decision of the 47th Assembly of Governors of 2025-11-28	MOVEMENT

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-10-01	AT 2026-10-12	PROGRESS
African Telecommunications Union (ATU)	Under the mandate set at the sixth session in Algiers in 2022, chaired by Algeria	A secretary general elected for the next four-year term, a 25-state administrative council seated, the chairmanship passed to Nigeria and a ministerial declaration adopted; the union's plenipotentiary conference ratified the return of its headquarters to Kinshasa on 23 July 2026, after the host state paid more than US$1.4m in arrears, with no date stated for the move	MOVEMENT
African Union Commission	Author of the Continental AI Strategy and the Digital Transformation Strategy, with no continental digital partnership agreement on record in the year before	Two cooperation instruments signed inside six months, with a US technology company and with the ITU, and a coordinated African position taken to the first global AI-governance dialogue	MOVEMENT
AFRINIC governance and receivership	Under an appeal-court order of 15 October 2024 directing the Official Receiver to complete the board election within two months, in substitution for the six months ordered in September 2023; no reconstituted board at the window's start, six months past that deadline	the board having constituted an Appeal Committee, appointments effective immediately for a term to 31 December 2026, and a public policy meeting called for Cape Town on 18 November 2026; candidate registration for one of the two policy-development co-chair seats opened on 1 October 2026 and closes on 29 October, with selection at the 18 November meeting	MOVEMENT
Algiers Declaration on African Telecommunications Sovereignty and Integrated Connectivity 2026-2030	Did not exist	Adopted as a continental position on integrated terrestrial, submarine and satellite infrastructure, local data centres, exchange points and cybersecurity; no work programme or text held	MOVEMENT
Cairo Declaration on child rights and design accountability	Did not exist	At drafting stage, its six pillars covering safety-by-design requirements, restrictions on exploitative targeting and manipulative practices, age-appropriate design standards and related obligations on companies	MOVEMENT
Cairo Document for Trust and African Digital Integration	Did not exist	Representatives of eleven African missions in Cairo agreed at a summit roundtable to develop a joint document setting shared priorities on digital investment, digital trade, cybersecurity, data governance and emerging technologies; no text or adoption date is published	MOVEMENT
Central African regional framework on cross-border data flows	Did not exist	Central African member states met in Douala from 31 August to 4 September 2026 to draft a regional framework governing cross-border data flows, assessing national readiness and consolidating country contributions into a consensus on the pillars of a future regional instrument. Technical and financial support came from the German development agency, a continental development agency, the Economic Commission for Africa and the African Union Commission, which frames the work against the continental digital transformation strategy for 2020 to 2030	MOVEMENT
Digital Parliaments Project Africa	Did not exist	Launch cohort of the parliaments of Ghana, Botswana and South Africa, the National Assemblies of the Gambia and Senegal, and the Pan-African Parliament, led by the POPVOX-DPP Foundation with the House Democracy Partnership; no amount, duration, funder or work programme stated	MOVEMENT

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-10-01	AT 2026-10-12	PROGRESS
Korea-Africa Economic Cooperation ministerial framework	A cooperation framework established in 2006 by the continental development bank, Korea's finance ministry and its export-import bank, whose trust fund had provided about US$50m for project preparation since 2007	The eighth ministerial, held in Seoul from 8 to 11 September 2026 with 45 African countries represented, adopted a Joint Declaration and a KOAFEC Action Plan for 2027-2028 putting artificial intelligence, digital infrastructure and human capital at the centre of the partnership, committing both sides to modular data centres suited to local conditions, AI models reflecting African languages and further public and private funding for electricity and telecommunications gaps. Around it the continental development bank signed letters of intent with Korea on strengthening the KOAFEC Trust Fund, whose cumulative Korean contributions it puts at US$132.82m as at 31 May 2026, with KAIST on a three-year framework for AI and digital governance training and research, and with the National Information Society Agency on data governance, AI-ready datasets and digital public infrastructure, alongside the Eximbank pact of 9 September	MOVEMENT
Lusaka Declaration on AI, data protection and privacy	Did not exist	Adopted by members of the Pan-African Parliament at the first Africa Digital Parliamentary Summit, convened with the African Population and Health Research Center and the GSMA, committing parliamentarians to data and digital literacy programmes for members and staff, to Africa-led AI governance frameworks, to national health information exchange protocols, and to data-governance and cybersecurity frameworks for manufacturing aligned to the Malabo Convention	MOVEMENT
Smart Africa Alliance	37 member states, working to the previous strategy	42 member states and a three-year strategy whose flagships are a data exchange, an innovation platform and digital identity; the secretariat issued two calls for expressions of interest on 13 August, one for content-delivery providers across broadband, data governance and cybersecurity and green-digital domains, and one for a consultancy to draft a gender-inclusion strategy for women's participation in ICT policymaking and governance, both closing on 31 August	MOVEMENT
Association of Regulators of Information and Communications for Eastern and Southern Africa (ARICEA)	Launched in January 2003 under COMESA's auspices as an association of ICT regulators in Eastern and Southern Africa, on its own account to ITU regulators (2003-12)	A COMESA-linked association of communications regulators across Eastern and Southern Africa, holding its 14th annual general meeting in Livingstone, Zambia, on 9 September 2026, at which COMESA's assistant secretary-general for programmes called for stronger, more predictable and more agile regulatory frameworks to match digital expansion across the region. Membership, mandate and any harmonisation instrument the association issues are not published in this account.	NO CHANGE
State parties to the AfCFTA	49 of 54 signatories had ratified and deposited their instruments with the AU Commission (2025-07)	49 of 54 signatories had deposited instruments of ratification as at July 2026, and Somalia is to become the 50th state party on depositing its instrument in September 2026, having agreed with the Secretariat a sequence running from ratification through domesticating the electronic tariff book and configuring preferential tariffs in its customs administration to a first shipment (2026-08)	NO CHANGE a fiftieth deposit announced for September 2026

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-10-01	AT 2026-10-12	PROGRESS
African common position for the ITU Plenipotentiary Conference 2026	BASELINE NOT HELD	The fourth and final African preparatory meeting closed in Abidjan on 17 September 2026 with 46 African Common Proposals ready for PP-26 in Doha, presided over by the chairman of Cote d'Ivoire's ARTCI regulatory council alongside the ATU secretary general-elect, the African Preparatory Meeting chair and the ITU Africa regional director; the proposals cover universal and meaningful connectivity, sustainable digital transformation, skills development and inclusive digital services, with space and spectrum regulation the most debated, and the next stage is the fourth inter-regional preparatory meeting in Saudi Arabia on 13-14 October 2026	BASELINE NOT HELD
African Continental Health Data Governance Framework	BASELINE NOT HELD	A draft continental framework put to a member-state consultative session convened by the continental disease-control agency and Transform Health at the Africa HealthTech Summit in Kigali, where the agency called on member states to strengthen national health data stewardship and adopt interoperable digital standards and said it is supporting them to build governance systems that keep national ownership of the data; no draft text or adoption timetable is published; the agency's head of digital health says the initiative started in 2025 with more than 40 member states and that the framework will guide who may access health data, for what purpose, for how long and under what safeguards, for countries to adapt	BASELINE NOT HELD
African Financial Stability Report	BASELINE NOT HELD	Inaugural 2024-2025 edition endorsed by the Association of African Central Banks' 47th Assembly of Governors at Yaounde on 2025-11-28 and released in July 2026, covering 46 countries on data as at December 2024; a second edition was approved by the Board of Governors at the 48th annual meetings in Nairobi, 13-18 September 2026, with the Central Bank of Egypt chairing the taskforce preparing it and publication to run through the African Financial Stability Committee's portal on the Association's website	BASELINE NOT HELD
African Monetary Institute	BASELINE NOT HELD	The Association of African Central Banks constituted the Institute's board at its 48th annual meetings in Nairobi, 13-18 September 2026, seating Egypt, Tunisia and Morocco for North Africa alongside 12 central banks across the Association's five regions; the account calls it the beginning of the Institute's activation and no mandate, staffing or timetable is published	BASELINE NOT HELD
African Union Archives and Repository Project	BASELINE NOT HELD	A project to establish an African Union archives and repository, dormant and now under reinstatement: the AU Commission received a South African delegation at headquarters in Addis Ababa on 7 September 2026 for an introductory meeting at the Cabinet of the Chairperson, reviewing background and current status and setting out the issues for a working visit. No scope, budget, timetable or hosting arrangement is published.	BASELINE NOT HELD
ATU Strategic Plan 2027-2031	BASELINE NOT HELD	A draft Strategic Plan for 2027-2031 was circulated to member states for comment ahead of CPL-26; the draft is not published, and no adopted plan, budget or final acts of the conference are held	BASELINE NOT HELD
COMESA regional AI strategy and model framework	BASELINE NOT HELD	A draft study of AI and emerging technologies across COMESA was put to member states for validation at Mbabane, as the first phase towards a regional AI strategy, model policy guidelines and a model regulatory framework under the World Bank-funded IDEA programme	BASELINE NOT HELD

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-10-01	AT 2026-10-12	PROGRESS
Model Law on Access to Information for Africa (2013)	Model law adopted by the African Commission on Human and Peoples' Rights (2013)	The Commission said on 28 September 2026 that it will review the model law next year to add digital-age provisions, beside Resolution 630 (guidelines for states to monitor technology companies on information integrity) and Resolution 631 (guidelines for platforms operating in Africa to serve the public interest), and that it will consider draft African Guidelines on Access to Data under Resolution 620	BASELINE NOT HELD
Primary Health Care Continental Coordination Mechanism (digital health forum)	BASELINE NOT HELD	Member states endorsed the mechanism, convened by the continental health agency in Addis Ababa on 5 June 2026, with a digital health and innovation forum for digital public infrastructure, interoperability and data governance, committing to apply the continental digital health maturity assessment tool, build costed digital health investment cases and strengthen health data governance and sovereign hosting; the outcome statement was posted on 8 October 2026	BASELINE NOT HELD

The institutional layer moved most. A council of 42 heads of state was established for artificial intelligence, a secretary general was elected at the telecommunications union, a continental sovereignty declaration was adopted for 2026-2030, and a parliaments project opened with a six-legislature cohort. The continental free trade area counts 49 of 54 signatories as having deposited ratifications, the count the AU reported in July 2025.

What has not moved is the digital trade protocol's own domestication: state parties committed to expedite it under eight calls to action and the repository still holds no ratification count. The regional registry remains under an appeal-court order and a receivership, and closed the year naming a chief executive designate for January 2027 while Mauritius police confirmed two alleged forgery cases arising from the board election it annulled without ever stating why. A mandate is cheaper to adopt than to work, and the difference between the two is what this section cannot yet show.

Instruments and harmonisation

Strategies, plans and policies

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-10-01	AT 2026-10-12	PROGRESS
Anti-IFFs Policy Tracker	Piloted eighteen months in Cote d'Ivoire, Ghana, Liberia, Namibia, Uganda and Zambia, built by Tax Justice Network Africa with the AU Commission's ETTIM department and the African Tax Administration Forum	Endorsed for continental roll-out as a standing self-assessment instrument scoring anti-IFF policy, legal, institutional and data-sharing frameworks; no roll-out timetable, country list or governance body named	MOVEMENT
AUDA-NEPAD island economies programme	Did not exist	A country-owned framework for seven island states built around industrialisation, digitalisation, corridors and AI, in partnership with the Republic of Korea; the ministerial communique adopting it is not published	MOVEMENT

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-10-01	AT 2026-10-12	PROGRESS
Africa Technology Policy Tracker	Launched with more than 555 data points covering thirty-five countries and the African Union, 1988-2024 (2024-12)	A continental register built by the Carnegie Endowment with the African Telecommunications Union, consolidating national digital-economy laws, policies and regulations across infrastructure, platforms, skills and innovation; it indexes adopted documents only, weights nothing and assesses neither implementation nor rights compatibility. The counts reported on 2026-07-30 are 60 documents for Nigeria, 59 for Rwanda and 19 for Zambia	NO CHANGE

Data protection

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-10-01	AT 2026-10-12	PROGRESS
Network of African Data Protection Authorities (NADPA-RAPDP)	Constituted under a statute adopted at Ouagadougou in September 2016 and amended at Casablanca on 23 February 2018, setting its mandate, membership, organs and funding from member dues (2018-02)	The Fifth Board - Cabo Verde, Cote d'Ivoire and Zimbabwe - signed a declaration on 3 September 2026 proclaiming 21 September as Africa Data Protection Day, executing a decision of the network's ninth annual general meeting in May 2026; no membership count, secretariat budget or work programme is held (2026-09)	MOVEMENT a commemorative declaration
Signatures and ratifications of the Malabo Convention	21 of 55 signed, 20 ratified or acceded and 20 deposited (2026-02-02, the depositary's register)	The depositary's register of 02/02/2026 records 21 signatures and 20 ratifications or accessions of 55 member states, four more than the most-cited 2025 figure and not the 16 that continues to circulate in commentary; Kenya, Egypt, Ethiopia, Morocco, Algeria, Tanzania, Uganda and Malawi are blank in all three columns. Equatorial Guinea, where the Convention was adopted and after whose then-capital it is named, signed on 2026-07-28 and has not deposited an instrument of ratification	MOVEMENT marginal
African Union Data Policy Framework	Endorsed by the AU Executive Council at its 40th Ordinary Session, 2-3 February 2022 (EX.CL/Dec.1144(XL)), as the continental reference framework, with an implementation Action Plan still to be developed; no member-state alignment count given (2022-02)	In force as the continental reference framework, with about a third of the 54 member states aligned to it on a 2026-08-11 analysis, and 25 national regulatory sandboxes recorded across 15 countries by late 2024; no compliance mechanism, reporting cycle or enforcement route is stated	NO CHANGE
Malabo Convention	In force, and the continental benchmark against which national data-protection regimes are measured	Unchanged in text; a majority of the Union's 55 members remain outside it twelve years after adoption	NO CHANGE

Standards

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-10-01	AT 2026-10-12	PROGRESS
Africa PKI Forum harmonisation of digital-trust rules	Did not exist	Participants called for harmonised African rules so that digital credentials, electronic signatures and documents can be verified across borders; nothing is adopted and no instrument, timetable or signatory list is on file. The call was renewed at a Nigerian technology expo on 2 and 3 September 2026, where the Nigerian identity commission's director-general named public key infrastructure the irreplaceable foundation for cross-border authentication, electronic signatures and accountability and urged national and subnational bodies to align certificate policies, trust-service governance, data-privacy and legal frameworks, and the AfCFTA secretary-general warned that national systems unable to communicate with one another would replace physical fragmentation with digital fragmentation	MOVEMENT
African Common Proposals for WRC-27	Preliminary African Common Proposals for WRC-27 and RA-27 are to be consolidated from the recommendations of the African Telecommunications Union's WRC-27 working groups at the third African Preparatory Meeting, Tunis, 7-11 September 2026, co-organised with Tunisia's Agence Nationale des Frequences; no proposal text is published	The third African Preparatory Meeting opened in Tunis on 8 September 2026 for four days, hosted by Tunisia's Agence Nationale des Frequences and coordinated by the African Telecommunications Union, working towards common African positions on broadband capacity, rural connectivity and future communications technologies; it follows the 11th Africa Spectrum Management Conference held in Tunis on 7 September 2026, at which the union's secretary-general singled out the mid-band ranges 2.3 to 4.8 GHz and 6 GHz as where alignment is most needed. No proposal text is published.	MOVEMENT

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-10-01	AT 2026-10-12	PROGRESS
AFRINIC Constitution (Bylaws)	Fifth version in force since December 2020, with no review under way	The Bylaws Review Committee ran a first consultation from 2026-04-20, extended on 2026-05-08 to close 2026-05-17, published a draft amended Constitution on 2026-08-04 for a second consultation that closed 2026-08-21, and opened a third round on 2026-08-25 closing 30 August while it reviews the second round's submissions. It has now obtained an independent external legal opinion on a dispute resolution clause and on the legality of the board's discretionary power to terminate resource membership, and states that it does not at this stage intend to recommend a dispute resolution clause and is considering options to strengthen the safeguards on the termination power; the opinion itself is withheld as privileged. The draft's Article 24, governing law and dispute resolution, was still blank in the 53-page draft members were asked to review provision by provision, carrying only a bracketed note that advice had been sought. A new Article 3 would write into the constitution that AFRINIC is the Regional Internet Registry for Africa and the Indian Ocean and that its governance will be periodically reviewed against internationally recognised governance standards; proposed article 9.8 would let a two-thirds board vote revoke the nomination committee and restart an election the board itself had judged to have failed; the current rule barring a conflicted director from voting would be dropped and recusal relocated into board policy, which matters because Mauritius company law lets an interested director vote after disclosure unless the constitution says otherwise; article 16 opens a wide advice channel with no register of advice given or received; and article 17.5 would create an acting chief executive office with no maximum term. The published-draft milestone slipped about six weeks against the Committee's own indicative timetable while the Special General Members Meeting stayed in September 2026, and no consolidation or analysis of any round's submissions is published	MOVEMENT
AFRINIC IPv4 policy proposal AFPUB-2026-IPv4-001 (soft landing, recovered space and priority)	In Last Call, with the quarantine procedure it depends on posted on 30 July 2026	Ratified, on a cleanup procedure setting a quarantine period of a tentative twelve months that may run longer but never shorter (2026-08); the Board ratified the policy on 25 September 2026 as AFPUB-2026-IPv4-001, listed as awaiting implementation with the cleanup workflow estimated at six months	MOVEMENT
AFRINIC IPv4 policy proposal AFPUB-2026-IPv4-002 (waiver of the 90% utilisation threshold)	Did not exist	an objection to the twelve-month quarantine floor in the published cleanup procedure carried past the Last Call boundary rather than resolved within it; the Board ratified the policy on 25 September 2026 as AFPUB-2026-IPv4-002, a documented-exception route around the 90% utilisation threshold, listed as awaiting implementation within 30 days	MOVEMENT
AFRINIC IPv6 policy proposal AFPUB-2026-v6-001 (IPv6 as a criterion in IPv4 soft landing)	Did not exist	Draft 2 submitted 14 June 2026 with an impact assessment dated 20 June 2026, proposing to amend article 5.4.4 of the Consolidated Policy Manual so that any IPv4 request from a party holding no IPv6 space must be accompanied by a simultaneous IPv6 request and a coherent deployment and addressing plan showing the network's actual top-25 IPv4 traffic destinations, with minimum compliance of 25% within 12 months, 50% within 24 and 75% within 48, or 25%, 75% and 95% over the same periods for content-hosting networks; AFRINIC 37 reached no consensus and the proposal returned to the policy mailing list rather than being adopted (2026-09)	MOVEMENT

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-10-01	AT 2026-10-12	PROGRESS
AFRINIC policy proposal AFPUB-2026-GEN-001-DRAFT02 (PDP Working Group guidelines and procedures)	Did not exist	A second draft under discussion would create a regional number council, community appeal and recall, and a petition route for the working group to ratify policy when no operative Board exists, opened by 15 supporters from three subregions; that route depends on a change to the Bylaws	MOVEMENT
Development bank programme on statistical data and metadata standards	Did not exist	The continental development bank's work to strengthen adoption of data and metadata standards across African statistical infrastructure, set out in a contribution to a central-bank statistics seminar held in October 2025 and published by the Bank for International Settlements in August 2026	MOVEMENT
Good Financial Grant Practice Standard, revised	a continental standard for financial grant management	a revised edition of that standard launched by the continental standardisation body with a research foundation	MOVEMENT
ISO-ARSO Kigali Agreement	Did not exist	A five-year technical-cooperation and standards-harmonisation framework between the international standards body and the African regional standards organisation, framed against the free-trade area's harmonisation push; no work programme, budget or standards list is published with it	MOVEMENT
Continental ICT standardisation alignment	A continental standardisation strategy for 2021-2025 on the Fourth Industrial Revolution, published by the IEEE Standards Association with the African standards organisation, framed by the AfCFTA (2021-04)	Talks opened on a coordinated continental approach across the standards lifecycle, from development through harmonised adoption and implementation by countries, naming fragmentation and the failure to translate continental and international standards into national frameworks as the problem	NO CHANGE the strategy period closed and alignment is at talks
AFRINIC policy proposal AFPUB-2026-GEN-003-DRAFT01 (Public Policy Meeting dates)	Draft received by the Policy Development Working Group (2026-09-14)	A draft policy proposal on Public Policy Meeting dates, authored by Jordi Palet, was received by the Policy Development Working Group on 14 September 2026 and opened for community comment by co-chairs Hytham El-Nakhal and Darwin Da Costa; within three days the resource policy discussion list divided over whether meeting scheduling belongs in the policy development process at all, one member arguing operational and administrative questions should stay out of it and the author replying that the process's scope includes the process itself in all five regional registries	BASELINE NOT HELD
ITU digital financial services security recommendations	BASELINE NOT HELD	Adopted by the southern and eastern African regulator associations, under consideration by the central African association and at draft stage with the west African one; the ITU's security lab reports assisting more than 20 countries, with eight regulators and the UPU now testing mobile-money apps independently	BASELINE NOT HELD

AI

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-10-01	AT 2026-10-12	PROGRESS
Africa AI Council	Did not exist	Established under a board of 42 heads of state with the AU Commissioner for Energy and Infrastructure and the ITU Secretary-General; no work programme or output held in the nine months since	MOVEMENT

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-10-01	AT 2026-10-12	PROGRESS
African Humanitarian AI Citation Index	Did not exist	an index measuring whose knowledge generative artificial-intelligence answers cite when explaining African humanitarian crises, published by its researcher	MOVEMENT
AI Made in Africa policy brief series	Did not exist	A joint initiative of GIZ and the African Observatory on Responsible AI, a flagship project of the Global Center on AI Governance, publishing fifteen policy briefs; two of the August 2026 briefs treat compute-resource inequality and public AI, and policy barriers to the growth of AI startups	MOVEMENT
Free student access to a commercial assistant	Did not exist	A technology company offered African students one year of its paid artificial-intelligence assistant tier at no charge, pitched at study materials, assignments and planning	MOVEMENT
Fund departmental paper on artificial intelligence in the region	Did not exist	A departmental paper on the potential of artificial intelligence across sub-Saharan Africa, held in full as published	MOVEMENT
Google Africa Applied AI Lab	Did not exist	A co-development programme based at the Accra AI Community Centre and run with the sponsor's AI futures fund, giving selected African startups from pre-seed to Series C+ pre-release access to its Gemini, Gemma and Veo models plus research mentorship and go-to-market support, with no equity taken and no cash award guaranteed; it closes with a demo day in Accra	MOVEMENT
Hub for AI and Disability Inclusion (HAIDI) and African Disability Data Network (ADDN)	Did not exist	A hub hosted by the Responsible AI Lab at KNUST and a discovery network, backed by IDRC, the UK FCDO and AI4D, set to inventory disability-related datasets, build three datasets including sign languages, assess disability inclusion in national AI strategies and fund three startups	MOVEMENT
Pan-African AI governance research and advocacy project	Did not exist	A four-year research and advocacy project on pan-African AI governance, funded at EUR 1,873,314 and running 2026 to 2030, implemented by a consortium of a German university media research centre and three civil-society organisations; the position it argues from is common principles through continental institutions rather than 54 national AI regimes, covering data governance, AI ethics, procurement standards, regulatory sandboxes, cross-border research and capacity-building	MOVEMENT
Africa AI Fund	Announced in April 2025 at US$60bn, alongside the Africa AI Declaration, with nothing capitalised	Still cited as one pillar of the continental AI architecture; no capitalisation, governance structure or disbursement held	NO CHANGE
AU Continental AI Strategy	Adopted 2024-07-19 as the continental reference for national AI policy, on an implementation timeframe running 2025 to 2030	Unchanged in text, and the reference the Commission carried into global forums; ministers meeting at the ECA called for its translation into national frameworks. The instrument's own timetable runs Phase I across 2025-2026, a midterm review in 2027 and Phase II from 2028	NO CHANGE
Common African Position on AI and its Impact on Peace, Security, Democracy and Development	Requested by the Peace and Security Council at its 1267th ministerial meeting, asking the Commission to elaborate the position; no text existed (2025-03)	The Council requested the Commission to expedite the comprehensive study and the Common African Position and submit them for its consideration; a Policy Brief on AI for Peace, Security and Governance in Africa is reported in progress and no text is published	NO CHANGE requested again and still unpublished
Monitoring and evaluation of the AU Continental AI Strategy	Provided for in the Strategy through an African AI readiness index, a public monitoring dashboard and regional AI observatories, with nothing published	Still nothing published; the Peace and Security Council requested the Commission and its AI Advisory Group to submit periodic reports on 2026-04-16, and the Strategy's own midterm review falls in 2027	NO CHANGE

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-10-01	AT 2026-10-12	PROGRESS
Training data for African languages	A survey of 734 papers found the continent's languages scarcely reflected in state-of-the-art systems, with resource creation active and growing (2025-05)	A research company has set out to build training data for a thousand African languages, after years in which the scarcity of that data was what stopped anyone building language technology for the continent (2026-09)	NO CHANGE a new target stated and nothing delivered
Artificial-intelligence startups counted in a continental census	669 AI startups among more than 900 AI stakeholders, in a separate continental mapping on different definitions and sources (2024-06)	224 firms across 22 countries and a Pan-African category, founded 2002 to 2025; 195 active and 18 defunct by operating status, and 143 early stage, 72 growth stage and 9 mature by stage	BASELINE NOT HELD the earlier count is from a different census and not a series
ATLAS Umoja AI policy workstream (AUDA-NEPAD)	BASELINE NOT HELD	A policy workstream on AI governance and African-language AI, launched and chaired by the continental development agency; a mobile industry body's regulatory chief said at the launch that fewer than 2% of African languages are meaningfully supported by today's models; no membership, workplan or output date is published	BASELINE NOT HELD
AU Guidelines on AI Governance and Regulation	BASELINE NOT HELD	A draft by the Commission's Infrastructure and Energy Department, framed as putting the Continental AI Strategy into practice, put to an open consultation opened on 23 September 2026, after which the draft guidelines and an AU model AI law are being prepared for ministerial review; the Commission's AI coordinator put the countries with a formally adopted national AI policy at 17, against eight when the Strategy was developed; no draft text or adoption date is published	BASELINE NOT HELD
Global Index on Responsible AI, African results	BASELINE NOT HELD	The 2026 edition finds African countries scoring high on AI skilling and capacity-building and low on labour protections, with African workers concentrated in the low-paid and precarious parts of the AI value chain	BASELINE NOT HELD
Public capital committed to the AU Continental AI Strategy	BASELINE NOT HELD	About US$150m of public capital committed by African governments against an implementation cost the Strategy itself prices at between US$250bn and US$500bn - a fraction of one per cent - and an ambition to add US$1.5 trillion to Africa's GDP by 2030; independent research over the Strategy's first eighteen months found the funding heavily concentrated in Kenya, Nigeria, South Africa and Egypt, with little reaching the remaining member states	BASELINE NOT HELD
Smart Africa Blueprint: Artificial Intelligence for Africa	BASELINE NOT HELD	The alliance secretariat's first-edition continental blueprint for artificial intelligence, held in full as published in 2021; no revision or second edition is held	BASELINE NOT HELD
Use of AI tools by judicial operators, and training for it	BASELINE NOT HELD	44 per cent of judicial operators use artificial-intelligence tools and 9 per cent have been given training in them, on the survey cited by the continental human rights court and UNESCO at a judicial capacity event; the gap between use and training is the finding, and neither the survey's sample nor its date is given in the account held	BASELINE NOT HELD
World Bank Africa Economic Update, October 2026: Building AI Readiness	BASELINE NOT HELD	The lender's twice-yearly regional report urged Sub-Saharan governments to invest in AI for productivity and jobs, pointing to low-cost applications on affordable devices, shared data centres and stronger data-protection laws, and put the region's 2026 growth at 4.3%, 0.3 of a point above its April edition	BASELINE NOT HELD

Open data

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-10-01	AT 2026-10-12	PROGRESS
Nwulite Obodo Open Data Licence	Version 1.0 published (2024)	Version 1.0, a tiered licence carrying ShareAlike terms for recipients in developing countries and benefit-sharing from recipients elsewhere, deployed as the licence of a University of Pretoria glossary dataset	NO CHANGE first record of a licence published in 2024

Harmonisation advanced on paper and stalled in law. The continental data policy framework is in force as the reference, with about a third of member states aligned to it; the cyber and data convention is unchanged in text and had 21 of 55 signatures and 20 ratifications at the depositary's February 2026 register.

On standards the work is opening rather than closing: common proposals for the 2027 radio conference are to be consolidated from regional recommendations, and talks opened on a coordinated approach across the standards lifecycle. The registry's bylaws review ran three consultation rounds without publishing an analysis of any of them, and concluded on a privileged legal opinion that it will not recommend the dispute resolution clause its drafts left blank. Its address-policy docket shows the same shape: a proposal to waive the utilisation threshold reached Last Call with an evidence rule that the justification be sufficiently documented and no list of what would document it. None has produced an adopted instrument inside the window.

Shared systems and infrastructure

Connectivity

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-10-01	AT 2026-10-12	PROGRESS
2026 Abuja Declaration on Meaningful Connectivity for Africa	Did not exist	Adopted, committing member states to technology-neutral regulation, continental harmonisation, fair access to spectrum and fibre, shared infrastructure and data governance; the text itself is not published	MOVEMENT
Advancing Digital Connectivity in Africa roadmap (GSMA and PDAA)	Did not exist	Sets three priorities - migrating more than 600 million 2G and 3G connections to 4G and 5G, joint energy and connectivity investment, and cheaper reach to rural areas - on analysis of 11 markets, finding that halving the usage gap in those markets could bring about 245 million more people online	MOVEMENT
Airtel Africa network expansion programme	US$670m of capital expenditure in the year to March 2025, below guidance on deferred data-centre spend, adding 2,583 sites and about 3,300 km of fibre, with close to 1,500 5G sites in five markets and US$725m-750m guided for the next year (2025-05)	US$1.1 billion earmarked by the operator for expansion and upgrade of its network across 14 African markets, its chief executive said in a broadcast interview reported 10 September 2026, with annual spending stated to have risen from about US$120 million to about US$390 million and Nigeria named its largest market.	MOVEMENT earmarked rather than committed

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-10-01	AT 2026-10-12	PROGRESS
Commercial 5G deployment and adoption across the continent	1.2% of Sub-Saharan mobile connections in 2023, forecast to reach 17% by 2030 (2024-11)	61 operators across 37 African markets had launched commercial 5G services by the end of May 2026, 40 of them also running 5G fixed wireless access, after first launches in Algeria, Comoros, Egypt, Libya, Mauritania, Morocco and Tunisia over the preceding twelve months; 5G connections in Africa are put at just under 100 million by the end of 2026, 6.2% of total mobile connections, against a projected 3.4 billion and 37% worldwide, and among sixteen focus countries only Mauritius and South Africa had 5G population coverage above 50% as of May 2026	MOVEMENT a Sub-Saharan measurement against a continental projection
Data customers and usage on the continent's largest operator	Average monthly data use of 10.8GB a customer	More than 307 million voice, 172 million data and 70 million mobile-money customers across sixteen markets at the end of 2025, with average monthly data use up to 12.5GB a customer from 10.8GB, on R38bn of capital spending on capacity, coverage and quality	MOVEMENT
Harmonised national broadband mapping project	Did not exist	A 2025-2028 project to establish or strengthen harmonised national broadband mapping systems in eleven sub-Saharan regulators - Benin, Botswana, Burundi, Ethiopia, Ivory Coast, Kenya, Malawi, Nigeria, Uganda, Zambia and Zimbabwe - with a five-day intermediate GIS and data-management training opened at Lilongwe for practitioners from Malawi, Zimbabwe, Botswana and Zambia, hosted by the Malawian regulator and supported by the European Union	MOVEMENT
Microsoft Africa connectivity commitment	Commitment made in 2022; 2025 target not yet reported met	Internet access provided to more than 117 million people in Africa through internet service providers, hardware producers and multilateral partners, which the company reports as exceeding its 2025 target	MOVEMENT
5G fixed wireless access operators	BASELINE NOT HELD	40 operators had launched 5G fixed wireless access across 37 African markets by May 2026	BASELINE NOT HELD
Africa Digital Connectivity Infrastructure Report	BASELINE NOT HELD	Phase 1, Country Pilots, put out as an open consultancy tender at a stated budget of US$165,000, funded jointly by the African Development Bank, the Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank and the Multilateral Cooperation Center for Development Finance; the pilot countries and the terms of reference are not established	BASELINE NOT HELD
IPv6 capability across the AFRINIC service region	56.2% of AFRINIC members held IPv6 resources, with 10,880 /32s allocated, at 30 June 2025 - a measure of address holding, not of user capability (2025-06)	Put at 6% against a world average of 44%, with only eight African countries above 20%, fifteen between 10% and 19% and fifteen below 1%; three million IPv4 addresses have been recovered under the soft-landing policy since 2020 without a proven rise in IPv6 deployment (2026-06)	BASELINE NOT HELD the earlier figure measures address holding and is not comparable
Mobile internet users and their measured economic value	27% mobile internet penetration in Sub-Saharan Africa, with mobile generating US$140bn, 7.3% of GDP, in 2023 (2024-11)	550 million internet users in 2025, 36 per cent of the population, 517 million of them on mobile; about 906 million people, some 60 per cent, live under mobile broadband coverage without using it, against 122 million, 8 per cent, beyond any last-mile network. Current projections reach about 700 million users by 2030, more than 300 million short of one billion (2026-09)	BASELINE NOT HELD the earlier figures cover Sub-Saharan Africa only

Data Storage

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-10-01	AT 2026-10-12	PROGRESS
Amazon Web Services investment in African cloud infrastructure	ZAR 15.6bn (about US$858m at the study's rate) spent on the Cape Town cloud region in 2018-2022, the first AWS region on the continent, live since April 2020 with three Availability Zones (2023-04)	More than US$819 million stated as invested in African infrastructure since 2018 and a further US$1.5 billion committed to 2029, with 154 services available in the Cape Town cloud region; the company's general manager for Sub-Saharan Africa told a Johannesburg summit on 10 September 2026 that its Africa strategy is increasingly aimed at local developers building for regional markets, and claimed more than one million Africans trained in cloud and AI skills.	MOVEMENT
Sovereign AI cloud on edge data centres	Did not exist	The operator's AI factory is ranked 36th on the global list of the most powerful supercomputers, presented as evidence that African organisations can train and deploy models on infrastructure sited on the continent rather than abroad; the underlying offer remains AI processing units hosted inside an African edge data-centre network and sold as locally-hosted enterprise AI	MOVEMENT
African share of global data-centre capacity	Under 1% of global data-centre capacity against 18% of the world's population, in a contributed opinion piece (2025-04)	Put at 0.6% of world data-centre capacity by the chief executive of a pan-African fibre operator, speaking on the sidelines of ITW Africa 2026 in Nairobi on 10 September 2026, who named it the concern African telecom executives raise most, with cross-border connectivity the only issue close to it.; the same 0.6 per cent figure is given by the data centres association alongside about 360 MW live, as a development finance institution approved about EUR 135m of equity to add 25 MW	NO CHANGE the estimates now carry named compilers
Continental data-centre capacity against projected demand	Five markets — South Africa, Nigeria, Kenya, Egypt and Morocco — named as the continent's principal data-centre hubs in a 2023 industry spotlight	About 360MW active, 238MW under construction and 656MW in the pipeline on the data centres association's 2026 count, against a consultancy estimate of demand rising from about 0.4GW to 1.5-2.2GW by 2030	NO CHANGE a first count with no earlier figure behind it
Continental dependence on foreign public cloud	Cloud and data infrastructure 'often supplied by and procured from private foreign service providers', and a significant portion of the region's public data captured and controlled by foreign data companies, on the AU's own account (2022-02)	African artificial-intelligence startups are exposed to hidden financial and operational risk where a large share of workloads sits with a single provider, against which a new generation of African-founded sovereign and low-latency cloud providers is emerging	NO CHANGE
Data centres the AfCFTA Secretariat states digital trade requires	BASELINE NOT HELD	More than 700, against about 220 on the continent, on the Secretary General's statement at Marrakech; restated in September 2026 as more than 700 within ten years for a digital economy put at USD 700bn, against about 260 counted now	BASELINE NOT HELD
Time for a data centre to reach 85% occupancy	BASELINE NOT HELD	Six to eight years in African markets against two to three in Europe, on the Africa Data Centres Association's 2026 Economic Report, which also puts 80-90% of the continent's data as still processed and stored abroad and projects the market at US$9.2bn by 2029	BASELINE NOT HELD
UNDP AI Infrastructure Activation programme	BASELINE NOT HELD	Country-hosted GPU compute designed, procured and deployed with public institutions in Kenya, Malawi, Rwanda, South Africa, Togo and Zambia under the timbuktoo initiative; 21 AI use cases submitted across the six, 20 of them below full data readiness, and Rwanda separately identifying 42 across eight sectors	BASELINE NOT HELD

Energy

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-10-01	AT 2026-10-12	PROGRESS
Digitisation priorities in the national energy compacts	Did not exist	The smart-metering and grid-optimisation priorities set out in the national energy compacts are argued to be constrained across Africa by a fragmented low-power internet-of-things layer: narrowband deployment reaches only markets such as South Africa, Kenya and Nigeria, while the 2G and 3G networks early smart meters rely on are expected to be retired well inside a meter's ten to fifteen year life; the analysis calls for integrated energy and telecom planning, targeted incentives for low-power wide-area network rollout, and energy-telecom co-investment	MOVEMENT
Emergent Grid Project (computing load as a mini-grid anchor customer)	Did not exist	Demonstrations placing flexible computing load at African mini-grids to test whether selling compute improves their economics: five new solar-plus-storage sites in Kenya for about 50,000 people, an under-used solar plant in DR Congo serving more than 30,000, and three rural sites in Sierra Leone, about 85,000 people in all, with community demand given priority over compute and outcomes independently evaluated	MOVEMENT

Cybersecurity

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-10-01	AT 2026-10-12	PROGRESS
Privileged access management for the African Union Commission's own networks	Did not exist	A request for bids for the supply and installation of a privileged access management solution for the Commission's own networks (Ref. ET-AUC-560865-GO-RFB), amended on 21 August 2026 to push the bid deadline from 27 August to 10 September 2026 and to restate the licence requirement as 8 administrator, 40 enterprise privileged-user, 25 business-user and 5 external-vendor subscriptions on three-year terms, with training raised from six staff to eight	MOVEMENT slipped
Reported cybercrime losses across the continent	About US$192m reported (2024)	About US$484m reported, more than double the 2024 figure, drawn from 36 member countries, with artificial intelligence involved in 55% of surveyed 2025 cybercrime cases and deepfake incidents up sevenfold between the second and fourth quarters of 2024; against that, only 8% of intelligence analysts are recorded as having advanced artificial-intelligence expertise and 94% of agencies as lacking digital forensics tools, and a single Ugandan deepfake investment scam is put at over US$2m of losses	REGRESSED
Vendor-measured attack volume across the continent	None published	African organisations averaged 3,237 attacks a week in July 2026 against a global average of 2,336, behind Latin America at 3,561 and Asia-Pacific at 3,316; Angola was highest of the African markets broken out at 5,714, then Nigeria at 4,975, Kenya at 2,915 and South Africa at 2,195. Ransomware victims were up 87% year on year and the continent posted the world's highest phishing rate at 1 in 106 emails	MOVEMENT

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-10-01	AT 2026-10-12	PROGRESS
Standing in the global cybersecurity index	Ghana, Kenya, Mauritius, Rwanda and Tanzania in Tier 1 (role-modelling); Benin, South Africa, Togo and Zambia in Tier 2 (advancing); the rest of the Africa region in Tiers 3-5, scored across legal, technical, organisational, capacity-development and cooperation measures (2024)	Mauritius, Rwanda, Kenya, Tanzania and Ghana in the top tier; Benin, Togo, Zambia and South Africa in the second; the majority of the continent below, scored across legal, technical and organisational measures, capacity building and international cooperation	NO CHANGE

Data Exchange

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-10-01	AT 2026-10-12	PROGRESS
ADAPT (Africa Digital Access and Public Infrastructure for Trade)	Did not exist	In pilot in Nigeria, Kenya and Morocco on the Secretary-General's statement to the second Digital Trade Forum; no live exchange, governing instrument or assessment held	MOVEMENT
AfCFTA Customs Modernisation Project	The AfCFTA's customs rules in force with no automated continental customs infrastructure, and a shared customs portal for electronic exchange between State Parties proposed by the IMF (2025-04)	A public-private partnership under which Bergmans Security Consultants and Supplies Limited mobilises the financing for customs digital solutions, secure electronic exchange of customs information, coordinated border management, One Stop Border Posts, transit systems, electronic cargo tracking, non-intrusive inspection technology, integrated data centres, multilingual customs portals, risk management and data analytics across participating State Parties; the agreement builds on a memorandum of understanding concluded in July 2026 and nothing is recorded as deployed; a US$3.1bn contract was signed with a Nigerian security consultancy to digitise customs across the 50 member states, aiming at real-time cargo tracking and reduced revenue leakage	MOVEMENT
Africa Accelerator for Digital Public Infrastructure (AA4DPI)	Did not exist	A UNDP initiative led jointly by the Regional Bureau for Africa and the Digital and AI Hub, supporting countries to assess digital readiness, strengthen governance and institutional coordination, build implementation capacity and develop investment-ready programmes across digital identity, digital payments and data exchange; its first published cohort session ran 2-3 September 2026 with delegations from Ethiopia, Malawi, Rwanda, Sierra Leone and Zambia. Its first convened activity was a two-week learning mission to India, concluded 7 September 2026, taking delegations from Ethiopia, Malawi, Rwanda, Sierra Leone and Zambia with African Union representatives through New Delhi, Pune and Bengaluru to examine digital identity, digital payment and data exchange systems	MOVEMENT
AU Digital Agriculture Strategy implementation	Adopted for 2024-2030 with an average agricultural growth target of 6 per cent and an estimated US$165 million continental implementation cost, prioritising national e-agriculture strategies over a uniform regional approach after a 2021 situation analysis covering all 55 member states	A continental workshop convened regional economic communities, union organs and participating countries to harmonise implementation, seeking interoperable agricultural data platforms, common data governance and alignment of national and regional systems with the continental digital transformation strategy and agriculture reporting	MOVEMENT

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-10-01	AT 2026-10-12	PROGRESS
Continental data governance frameworks	Did not exist; the AU Data Policy Framework recommended developing a Cross Border Data Flows Mechanism and a Common Data Categorisation and Sharing Framework (2022-02)	Three drafts - data categorisation and data sharing, cross-border data flows, and a continental open data strategy - validated with member states and regional economic communities; none submitted to AU policy organs and none published	MOVEMENT
IGAD SDMX regional statistical-systems capacity-building programme	Did not exist	Outcome stated as harmonised SDMX Data Structure Definitions and a long-term roadmap institutionalising SDMX across IGAD and its member states under Open Data Portal 2.0; no budget, adoption date or roadmap milestone published	MOVEMENT
Petroleum producers' local content platform	Did not exist	a shared database mapping skills, industrial capacities and local suppliers across member countries, opened in Brazzaville and described by its owner as the first pan-African platform dedicated to local content	MOVEMENT
SADX (Smart Africa Data Exchange)	Did not exist	Unveiled at Conakry on 2025-11-12 and taken into a technical mission with Rwanda, Benin and Ghana on trust chains, interface contracts and incident response; no live exchange held; the alliance and a German development agency say a digital identity issued in one of Rwanda, Ghana or Benin is now recognised in the other two, with eighteen further countries said to be joining, presented as the first step to a single African digital market by 2030	MOVEMENT
AU Data Policy Framework	In force since February 2022 as the continental reference for data governance, with none of its operative texts drafted	Unchanged in text; the three operative frameworks it provides for went to validation in December 2025 and none is adopted or published	NO CHANGE
AU Guidelines for Integrating Data Provisions in Protocols on Digital Trade	Issued September 2023 as a reference guide for negotiators integrating data provisions into the AfCFTA Protocol on Digital Trade	Unchanged; no record is held of its provisions being carried into the Protocol or its annexes	NO CHANGE
Smart Africa cross-border data exchange guidelines	Drafted by eleven member states under the Council of African IT Agencies	No adopted text, signatory list or implementation record held in the year since the drafting session	NO CHANGE

Digital Identity and CRVS

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-10-01	AT 2026-10-12	PROGRESS
ADLI cohort on the AfCFTA Digital Identity Annex	Did not exist	Six countries across three trade corridors working on compliance with the annex, on a test-and-learn basis; no assessment or mutual-recognition decision held	MOVEMENT
APAI-CRVS (Africa Programme on Accelerated Improvement of Civil Registration and Vital Statistics)	Running on a costed strategic plan for 2017-2021 of US$25,737,600, the first half of the 2017-2026 decade, which set at least 70% birth and 35% death registration coverage in every African country by 2021 (2017-11)	The 2017-2026 decade is closing and a 2027-2036 phase is opening; the African eCRVS Shared Asset (ACSA) is named as the shared continental standard intended to cut fragmented digital procurement across country systems, and Equatorial Guinea's Justice Ministry timed a free registration campaign for children aged 0-5 (10-14 August 2026) to the decade's close. No AU statement of the new phase's content, financing or targets is held	NO CHANGE a next phase reported opening but not adopted

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-10-01	AT 2026-10-12	PROGRESS
Smart Africa digital identity blueprint	First-edition blueprint published, setting out the Smart Africa Trust Alliance, levels of assurance and mutual recognition of member-state digital identities, drawn from a Benin-hosted working-group workshop of 31 March-2 April 2020 (2020)	The alliance secretariat's first-edition blueprint for mutually recognised digital identity across member states, setting out the trust alliance, levels of assurance and the case for interoperable identity, drawn up after a member-state workshop	NO CHANGE
Adults holding official identification in Sub-Saharan Africa	78% of eligible adults held their economy's foundational ID across 36 Sub-Saharan economies, Findex 2021 round (published 2024-07)	81% of adults, 82% of men against 79% of women, a 3.56-point gender gap (2025)	BASELINE NOT HELD the earlier figure covers eligible adults in 36 economies and is not on the same basis
Continental ID and data-protection law analyser	BASELINE NOT HELD	An open-source tool launched by a university research network comparing identity and data-protection laws across more than 50 African countries, built as a retrieval-augmented chatbot and stated as intended to help states harmonise their frameworks; no usage figure, governance arrangement or maintenance commitment is published	BASELINE NOT HELD

Digital Payments and Fintech

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-10-01	AT 2026-10-12	PROGRESS
African take-up of China's Cross-Border Interbank Payment System	Standard Bank licensed as the first African bank to transact through China's Cross-Border Interbank Payment System, with CIPS transactions due on its platforms from September 2025 (2025-06)	A bank operating in 34 African countries said on 9 October 2026 that it would sign an agreement in China the next day to join the Cross-Border Interbank Payment System for yuan transactions and is in talks to offer yuan settlement jointly with a Chinese bank; a Rwandan bank is reported to have joined and an Angolan bank to plan to; a cross-border payments startup launched direct yuan payouts in September 2026	MOVEMENT
Association of African Central Banks (AACB)	No decision of the Assembly on continental payment harmonisation held	A list of 54 decisions, of which decision 21 rules that the Payment Systems Directive for Africa is not to be led by an entity external to central banks and directs its own task force to lead the work	MOVEMENT
Banks and countries connected to PAPSS	28 banks within nine months of launch, against an ambition of all 500 to 600 African banks (2022)	30 countries connected and about 200 financial institutions live, against a target of about 38 countries and 80% continental coverage by the end of 2026 and full continental coverage within five years; I&M Bank Kenya went live for customers on 20 September 2026, sending to participating African markets in Kenyan shillings through its branches, with no volume, fee, corridor or transaction-limit detail published	MOVEMENT marginal
CARICOM Payment and Settlement System (CAPSS)	Did not exist; modelled on PAPSS since CARICOM governors' unanimous October 2023 selection	Proof of concept complete in two countries; the ECCB Governor says at least two more central banks are needed for the initial pilot; not commercially operational, with settlement, FX, liquidity, AML and interoperability arrangements unresolved	MOVEMENT

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-10-01	AT 2026-10-12	PROGRESS
COMESA digital retail payments platform	Deployment support planned across eight pilot countries under a EUR10m EU-financed programme, with the implementation plan still to be drawn up after a scoping workshop in Nairobi (2025-03)	The regional clearing house published the scheme rulebook setting operational and governance rules for instant low-cost cross-border retail payments, and a gender audit and strategy to 2030 drawn from research along the Malawi-Zambia corridor; it advertised three platform posts on 24 August 2026 - head of technology, platform and infrastructure engineer and security engineer - whose duties establish that the platform is built on Mojaloop, runs an AWS production environment against an on-premises staging footprint and Kubernetes clusters, and that the engineering, infrastructure and information-security functions are being recruited rather than staffed	MOVEMENT
Commercial stablecoin payout rail across African markets	Crypto, stablecoins among it, already used for business payments and small retail transfers, with US$125bn of on-chain value received July 2023 to June 2024; no commercial stablecoin payout partnership on record (2024-10)	A stablecoin payments platform partnered a local payout provider to widen stablecoin payouts across African markets, letting businesses settle into local currency through the partner's rails (2026-09)	MOVEMENT
Fintech volume carried by the continent's largest operator	23 billion transactions carrying more than US$500bn across the whole of 2025, up 15% in volume	13.0 billion transactions carrying US$330.5bn in the half, up 17.2% in volume and 33.8% in value in constant currency, on 70.8 million monthly active mobile-money users	MOVEMENT
Mastercard collaborations with the Mojaloop Foundation and AfricaNenda	Did not exist	The card network is to explore pairing its account-to-account fraud-scoring and dispute-resolution service with the open-source instant-payment software, and to work with AfricaNenda on policy and governance support for instant payment systems	MOVEMENT
Mastercard Wallet Pay (wallet interoperability services)	Did not exist	A card network's portfolio of wallet interoperability, card issuing, acceptance and cross-border money movement for digital wallet providers, with the continent's largest mobile operator's mobile-money business and a second operator group's two wallet services among its African launch partners	MOVEMENT
Pan-African Payment and Settlement System (PAPSS)	Operating from January 2022 across West and East African cores, with no Central African central bank participating	Operating across 30 African countries and into Central Africa since the regional central bank's July 2026 accession, settling in an average of seven seconds against an original 120-second design target. Payments across the network are reported to have grown about tenfold over the year while the average payment fell to about a fifth of its level a year earlier, which is a shift from a few large transfers towards many small ones, and a national switch is piloted for termination on it for the first time	MOVEMENT
PAPSSCARD	Did not exist	A continental card scheme launched to route African card payments inside the continent rather than through global networks; no issuance, volume or country coverage held. Afreximbank is connecting the scheme to Egypt's Meeza national card network so cards issued on either side work across more African markets: a first phase joining the two infrastructures and establishing a settlement layer, payment in the currency of the country being visited, debit and prepaid cards carried with credit a possibility, and no availability date given	MOVEMENT

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-10-01	AT 2026-10-12	PROGRESS
Payment Systems Directive for Africa (PSDA)	A proposed harmonisation framework for digital financial services, with a feasibility study being procured to test it and draft a framework and roadmap (2025-03)	Directed to be led by central banks rather than an external entity, with the Assembly's own task force on payment system integration to lead harmonisation; no draft directive held; the framework was presented in Nairobi on 5 October 2026, renamed harmonisation of regulation to enable cross-border payments, after a feasibility study found it feasible; three things are set before implementation, a binding continental legal instrument, a supervisory authority anchored in the central banks' association with a funded secretariat, and a US$120m implementation fund, under a ten-year roadmap naming five regional blocs as pathfinders and Nigeria-Ghana as a pathfinder corridor	MOVEMENT
Regulatory obstacles to instant payment interoperability	Did not exist	instant payment systems across the continent described as meeting a regulatory wall, with divergent national rules limiting interoperability	REGRESSED
Stablecoin settlement rails serving African cross-border payments	Surveyed by the IMF as an emerging cross-border payment use alongside fast payments and central bank digital currencies, with a recommended regulatory stance and no African operator or regulator having settled a treatment (2025-05)	Described by a pan-African payments operator's product chief as moving from speculative use into the plumbing of remittances and business settlement, on the evidence of Mastercard's agreement to acquire BVNK at up to US$1.8bn and Visa's stablecoin-card expansion through Stripe's Bridge into more than 100 countries, African markets among them; a first named African deployment is Flutterwave's tie-up with Caliza offering USD accounts with USDC and USDT conversion. At a UN Economic Commission for Africa webinar on 18 August 2026, market supervisors from Uganda's Capital Markets Authority, the Bank of Ghana and the Financial Services Commission of Mauritius set out three national approaches to virtual assets and stablecoins and agreed on consumer protection, financial stability, regulatory clarity and monetary sovereignty as shared objectives, arguing that compatible outcomes and supervisory cooperation matter more than identical legislation; the Commission put continental digital-asset users above 54 million, Nigeria alone at about 25.9 million, against a global tokenised money market that passed US$300bn in 2025. On 5 September 2026 the chief executive of the Pan-African Payment and Settlement System disclosed that the system is exploring ways to support stablecoins and other digital currencies within its payments ecosystem, naming the Central Bank of Nigeria and the Securities and Exchange Commission as regulators whose approach he endorsed, and said announcements could follow	MOVEMENT
TerraPay-Alipay+ cross-border QR acceptance	Did not exist	An announced partnership under which 15 African digital wallets connected to TerraPay's Xend interoperability network would be able to pay at more than 150 million merchants in the Alipay+ ecosystem, extending the network from account-to-account transfers into in-store payments	MOVEMENT
UnionPay online acceptance through Standard Bank	A collaboration between the two parties dating from 2024, with no merchant count published	Online-payment acceptance for nearly 900 merchants across Botswana, Ghana, Kenya, Malawi, Namibia, Tanzania, Uganda, Zambia and Zimbabwe, settling in local currency, US dollars or both, against a stated African footprint of about 7 million UnionPay cards issued	MOVEMENT
Verto Card (multi-currency corporate card on Visa)	Did not exist	A corporate card for African businesses that funds, spends and settles in 11 currencies from linked wallets, running on the card network's commercial rails; mobile-wallet integration and white-label card issuance for banks and fintechs announced as next	MOVEMENT

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-10-01	AT 2026-10-12	PROGRESS
Unmet trade finance demand	About US$100bn a year, on the continental trade lender's own estimate (2025)	US$74bn to US$100bn of unmet trade finance demand, with commercial banks intermediating about 23% of the continent's trade against 40% over 2011 to 2019, and intra-African trade at US$213.8bn in 2025 (2026-08)	NO CHANGE estimates from different lenders range from US$74bn to US$100bn
Airtel Money	BASELINE NOT HELD	Mobile-money platform in 13 African markets with about 53 million monthly active users at 30 June 2026; announced a London listing in which existing shareholders sell and no new capital is raised, with the IFC to buy up to GBP67.2m of shares; prospectus due in early October 2026; the offer price was set on 1 October 2026 at GBP1.96 a share, implying a market capitalisation at admission of GBP5.3 billion (about US$7.0 billion on the parent's conversion): existing shareholders sell 270 million shares plus up to 27 million under an over-allotment option, leaving about 16.5% in public hands, with admission to the London main market expected on 14 October 2026; conditional dealings began on 9 October 2026 after an oversubscribed offer raising about US$703 million for the selling shareholders, the shares touching GBP2.00 before trading at GBP1.93, just under the offer price, and the IFC taking its full cornerstone allocation of GBP67.2 million	BASELINE NOT HELD
Cost of sending money within Africa	BASELINE NOT HELD	Put at 8.78% of the amount sent against the SDG target of 3% (2026-08)	BASELINE NOT HELD
Cost of sending US$200 to Sub-Saharan Africa	BASELINE NOT HELD	Put at 8.46% of the amount sent in the third quarter of 2025 against a global average of 6.36% and the United Nations target of 3%, with banks the costliest channel at close to 15% on average, much of it carried in exchange-rate spreads rather than disclosed fees (2025-Q3)	BASELINE NOT HELD
Instant payment systems in operation	BASELINE NOT HELD	Every active domestic and regional instant payment system on the continent inventoried and ranked for inclusivity, as at June 2022; the fifth edition (2026), previewed by its publisher, finds on more than a decade of data from 54 economies that a live instant payment system raises how often account holders use their accounts but not whether people hold one, and that the average transaction value fell from US$58 in 2021 to US$25	BASELINE NOT HELD

Registries

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-10-01	AT 2026-10-12	PROGRESS
OHADA Uniform Act on General Commercial Law (AUDCG) and the RCCM business register	In force since 2011-05-15, creating and governing the Registre du Commerce et du Credit Mobilier, the merchant and entreprenant statuses, the national and regional company-record files and their computerisation (2011-05)	The founding instrument for the business register across OHADA's seventeen member states: it creates and governs the Registre du Commerce et du Credit Mobilier, defines the merchant and entreprenant statuses, sets the register's organisation and registration rules and the national and regional company-record files, and provides for their computerisation	NO CHANGE

Sectoral management information systems

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-10-01	AT 2026-10-12	PROGRESS
Africa CDC Central Data Repository	Did not exist	A federated repository integrating national surveillance, laboratory and programme data in which member states retain ownership of their data	MOVEMENT

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-10-01	AT 2026-10-12	PROGRESS
African Initiative on Transforming Health Financing (ECA)	Did not exist	A five-year Economic Commission for Africa initiative running 2026 to 2030, launched in Tangier in April 2026, built on seven interlinked outcomes of which digital governance is one, alongside fiscal embedding, innovative financing instruments, primary health care modernisation, regional public goods, institutional capacity and narrative transformation. Its digital component is a shared data and intelligence platform for quantifying national financing gaps, real-time interoperable health and budget data, and what the Commission's chief of staff called a digital twin of the health budget underwriting multi-year compacts between finance and health ministries; the Commission puts fewer than a third of health systems in low-income settings as able to track spending digitally in real time, governments as financing under 41% of total health expenditure on average, and 30 to 40% of health spending as lost to inefficiency	MOVEMENT
Continental behavioural intelligence and infodemic management framework	Did not exist	The continental disease control body and member states validated components of a behavioural intelligence and infodemic management framework at a five-day meeting in Mombasa ending 3 September 2026, with technical experts and public health leaders from Burundi, Ghana, Kenya, Mauritania, Sierra Leone and Zimbabwe alongside a West African regional surveillance centre and a WHO infodemic response alliance. The framework is to connect community feedback, social listening, behavioural and social data, service-delivery and programme data and rapid research into decision-ready intelligence; the continental body states explicitly that it is not another database or reporting platform, and provides stewardship through common standards, technical guidance, coordination and quality assurance while member states retain control of national systems	MOVEMENT
Regional Health Data Hub	Did not exist	a shared digital platform launched from Addis Ababa at the Seventy-sixth session of the Regional Committee for Africa, integrating fragmented health data across all 47 member states of the region and bringing maternal, newborn, child and adolescent health together with noncommunicable disease data; it carries 53 datasets and 7,965 indicators, about 65% of them ingested against a target of 80% by the end of 2026, and its governance framework is still in development (2026-09)	MOVEMENT
African Regional Integration Synthesized Index (ASRII) platform	BASELINE NOT HELD	The African Union Commission's platform for submission, validation, automated computation and dissemination of regional integration scores across political, economic, infrastructure, and human and social pillars, developed with the regional economic communities, the Economic Commission for Africa and the African Development Bank to replace manual data collection. Deployment to the regional economic communities began with a four-day training of 20 core participants at the ECOWAS Commission in Abuja on 4-7 August 2026, at which its Secretary General said the Commission holds no centralised database of the status, amendments and implications of regional legal protocols	BASELINE NOT HELD
Behavioural intelligence framework and data architecture	BASELINE NOT HELD	The continental health agency has validated a framework, a strategy, a digital and data architecture and a roadmap for harmonising behavioural intelligence across member states; none of the four documents is published, so scope, data sources, member-state obligations and timetable are all unstated	BASELINE NOT HELD

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-10-01	AT 2026-10-12	PROGRESS
DIGIT-HCM health-campaign digitisation initiative	BASELINE NOT HELD	A three-year WHO regional initiative, built with the eGov Foundation and supported by the Gates Foundation, to digitise the planning, delivery and monitoring of health campaigns on an open, modular platform, starting with seven pilot countries	BASELINE NOT HELD
Regional agricultural data systems	BASELINE NOT HELD	The fourth phase of a regional food system resilience programme, committed at US$43m in March 2026, builds the agricultural data systems and information infrastructure behind regional innovation in its first component. No disbursement is yet recorded	BASELINE NOT HELD

Use of satellite data

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-10-01	AT 2026-10-12	PROGRESS
African Meteorological Satellite Application Facility (AMSAF)	Did not exist	A continental facility inaugurated under the European Union-funded Strengthening Early Warning in Africa project, developing coordinated satellite-derived nowcasting and impact-based forecasting products for African meteorological services on Meteosat Third Generation data; no participating-service count, budget or product schedule is published	MOVEMENT
West and Central Africa biomass productivity monitoring	Did not exist	A humanitarian agency's regional biomass yearly production and anomaly tables, computed from Copernicus dry-matter productivity using Sentinel-3 OLCI, PROBA-V and SPOT-VEGETATION data and published to administrative level 3 across West and Central Africa; the held capture is the dataset listing rather than the data	MOVEMENT

The shared-infrastructure record is the one place where continental numbers exist, and they are uncomfortable. The trade secretariat's own estimate is that digital trade requires several times the number of data centres the continent has, and a facility here takes two to three times as long to reach the occupancy that finances it as one in Europe — the gap is the demand curve as much as the capacity.

Against that, an African operator's AI factory took a place in the top fifty of the global supercomputer list, which is a capability statement rather than a utilisation one. A connectivity declaration was adopted at Abuja, a harmonised broadband mapping project runs to 2028, and a continental infrastructure report reached its first country pilots as an open tender. Commercial 5G now runs from 61 operators in 37 markets, but of the sixteen countries the industry's own study examines only Mauritius and South Africa cover more than half their population, so the technology's footprint is a market count rather than a reach. The union commission meanwhile put its own privileged-access management out to bid, which is the smallest and most concrete item in the section.

Coordination and collaboration

ICT Industry

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-10-01	AT 2026-10-12	PROGRESS
Africa Semiconductor Technical Advisory Group (ASTAG)	Did not exist	An advisory group convened by AUDA-NEPAD with the CSIR, the African Academy of Sciences, South Africa's science ministry and a private partner, given twelve months to produce a refined Africa Semiconductor Roadmap for 2026-2030, a map of existing continental capability and frameworks for pooled regional infrastructure, across seven work streams running from critical minerals to RISC-V chip design	MOVEMENT
Charging for business messages on a dominant messenger	Service messages on the business platform free of charge	Free service messages to end from 1 October 2026, with businesses charged for every delivered message at rates varying by country and by message type, a cost increase for African companies that rely heavily on the messenger for customer service	REGRESSED
Structural separation of MTN's fibre business (Bayobab)	Under way (2025-04)	The continental operator reports fibre and data centres together as a digital-infrastructure platform and names advancing the separation of its fibre business, Bayobab, as a priority to attract capital	NO CHANGE
Open-source developer population	BASELINE NOT HELD	9,338,511 developer accounts across Africa in the first quarter of 2026, committers up 18 per cent over 2025, and Kenya densest at 11.9 accounts per 1,000 people	BASELINE NOT HELD

Innovation ecosystem

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-10-01	AT 2026-10-12	PROGRESS
Foundation startup incubation cohort	Did not exist	A foundation-funded incubation programme opened applications for a second continental cohort of technology startups	MOVEMENT
Multi-country mapping of innovation-support organisations	An earlier mapping under the same Europe-Africa programme in 2022, with workshops in Tunis, Kigali and Dakar feeding a planned white paper covering 12 countries (2022-05)	A EUR120,000 procurement opened by a European development agency for a multi-country mapping of African entrepreneurship- and innovation-support organisations under a Europe-Africa digital innovation programme	MOVEMENT a second mapping procured
ATU Africa Innovation Challenge	BASELINE NOT HELD	The African Telecommunications Union opened applications for a fifth edition on 17 September 2026 with a US$60,000 prize pool, launched in Abidjan by Cote d'Ivoire's Minister of Digital Transition and Technological Innovation during the fourth African Preparatory Meeting for the ITU Plenipotentiary Conference; the call invites solutions from academic and innovation ecosystems with a stated focus on AI-based software, and no entry count, winner or award date is held for this or earlier editions	BASELINE NOT HELD

US / hyperscaler activities

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-10-01	AT 2026-10-12	PROGRESS
America First Global Health Strategy data-sharing agreements	Did not exist; no bilateral United States health agreement of this kind on record before December 2025	Memorandums worth US$20bn signed with more than 30 countries since December 2025, on a model Data Sharing Agreement giving the United States at-will access to seven classes of national health system for 25 years with a 10-year post-termination tail; Ghana refused in April 2026, Zimbabwe withdrew in February 2026 and Zambia shelved in May 2026, and Kenya's framework is before the Court of Appeal with a final ruling due at the end of October 2026; the State Department's standard-form memorandum, held as a blank template dated 2026-03-11, commits a partner government to name and run its electronic medical record, laboratory, pharmacy, surveillance, commodity-inventory and national data warehouse systems, to load 90 per cent of clinical encounters into the electronic medical record within two years of rollout in a facility, to enter a data sharing agreement expected to run twenty-five years, and to provide specimens and genetic sequence data of pathogens with epidemic potential within five days of detection, with section 4.7 making failure on those commitments grounds for changing or discontinuing the assistance; the signed texts are withheld, the department having published a subset of the memorandums in March 2026 and then removed public access, and a freedom-of-information suit covering sixteen African countries (Public Citizen v. Department of State, No. 1:26-cv-01137, D.D.C.) was unresolved when filed on 2026-04-02; a rights organisation's clause-by-clause assessment of the seven signed memorandums it holds - Ethiopia, Kenya, Mozambique, Nigeria, Rwanda, Liberia and Uganda - reports that the model's terms were not applied uniformly: all seven require broad audit access, three (Liberia, Mozambique and Rwanda) commit to supplying any data requested for that audit with no privacy safeguard stated, two (Liberia and Nigeria) defer the data-sharing arrangement to an unpublished appendix, and the specimen and pathogen-sequencing clause appears in five of the seven, with Liberia and Kenya outside it Eight United States senators wrote to the Secretary of State in the week to 2026-08-19 challenging the demands for direct access to partner governments' own health-data systems as a condition of lifesaving aid, calling them unprecedented and at odds with United States policy on the data of American citizens, and requesting a briefing on the agreements' data requirements and a written answer by the end of August 2026.	MOVEMENT refused by three states and challenged in the United States Senate
US-AUC Strategic Investment Working Group	Did not exist	Agreed to channel US private investment into AU-backed infrastructure including digital transformation, on an investment-in-place-of-aid posture; no membership, meeting or work programme held	MOVEMENT

China activities

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-10-01	AT 2026-10-12	PROGRESS
African membership of the World Artificial Intelligence Cooperation Organisation	Did not exist	Ten African states joined the twenty-nine founding members of a new World Artificial Intelligence Cooperation Organisation agreed at the 2026 World AI Conference in Shanghai, where the body is to be headquartered; Algeria, Cameroon, Ethiopia, Kenya and South Africa are among the African founders. The same announcement carried 5,000 artificial-intelligence training places for developing countries over five years and international application cooperation centres with partners including the African Union	MOVEMENT
ATU memorandum with the China Academy of Information and Communications Technology	The Union and the Chinese academy partnering on an SME digital-transformation initiative presented at WSIS, with no memorandum between them reported (2025-07)	A memorandum signed in 2025 between the African Telecommunications Union and the China Academy of Information and Communications Technology on joint research, capacity development, technology transfer and next-generation networks, which the Union names as the foundation for its Secretary-General's participation in an Advanced Seminar on African Digital Development and Transformation that opened in Hangzhou on 24 August 2026, where he carried the priorities of its 52 member states	MOVEMENT signing date not held
AXIAN Telecom-Huawei strategic memorandum	Did not exist	A strategic memorandum across digital connectivity, digital finance and digital operations, covering 5G, cloud-based networks and AI-driven operations in the group's African operating markets; no value, project list or timetable is stated	MOVEMENT
Chinese artificial-intelligence cooperation centres with the African Union	A commitment in the 2025-2027 FOCAC action plan to jointly build a China-Africa digital technology cooperation center; no operating institution (2024-09)	The China-Africa Digital Technology Cooperation Center was formally inaugurated at Hangzhou on 28 August 2026 as a standing operational platform for results display, market-entry services, industry matchmaking, training and development research, four days after running its first high-level training programme; the opening drew officials, think tanks and executives from 18 African countries and the African Telecommunications Union, UNDP, UNICEF and the Smart Africa Alliance, and a same-day matchmaking session produced cooperation intentions in digital infrastructure, AI applications, cybersecurity and digital-skills training	MOVEMENT
Chinese intelligent weather-warning system in Africa	Did not exist	China signed agreements with Cote d'Ivoire, Guinea and Cameroon to extend an intelligent weather-warning system across Africa, and plans deployment in 30 countries; a second-generation Djibouti installation raises forecast resolution from 9km to 3km	MOVEMENT
China-Africa Digital Cooperation Development Action Plan	Issued 2024-07-29 by China and 26 African states across six cooperation actions, with a three-year target of ten joint digital transformation demonstration projects and 1,000 personnel trained	Unchanged; no progress report, no accession beyond the original 26 states and no delivery against the three-year targets is held	NO CHANGE

EU activities

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-10-01	AT 2026-10-12	PROGRESS
AU-Germany strategic dialogue	No dated session held in the repository	Reviewed the partnership and named AI governance and cybersecurity among the areas for cooperation, within a dialogue that is principally about peace and security	MOVEMENT marginal

India activities

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-10-01	AT 2026-10-12	PROGRESS
India-Africa digital public infrastructure cooperation	Did not exist	Delegations from Ethiopia, Malawi, Rwanda, Sierra Leone and Zambia completed a two-week mission to India under the UNDP's Africa Accelerator for Digital Public Infrastructure, travelling through Delhi, Pune and Bengaluru to examine India's digital identity, payment and data-exchange systems; no cooperation instrument, financing or country adoption commitment is published as an outcome.	MOVEMENT

External engagement arrived faster than the continent's own coordination. The United States agreed a working group to channel private investment into union-backed infrastructure and signed bilateral health data-sharing agreements with seven states; China opened the first training programme under an announced artificial-intelligence cooperation and continues a 2024 action plan with 26 African states; Germany reviewed its strategic dialogue.

None of the three carries a disbursement, a site or a delivery date in the repository. What the section can show is the shape of the approach rather than its effect, and a commercial decision — a dominant messenger ending free service messages on its business platform — is the item most likely to have reached an African user this year.

Capacity and inclusion

Training and skills

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-10-01	AT 2026-10-12	PROGRESS
AI training for African public officials (AfDB, UNDP AI Hub, Google, Apolitical)	Did not exist	Free self-paced courses on AI fundamentals, AI leadership and AI-assisted procurement, developed by Stanford University Online and SDA Bocconi, open to serving officials in the development bank's regional member countries	MOVEMENT
AYCE Digital (Advancing Youth Careers and Employment)	Did not exist	Launched as a five-year foundation-funded digital-skills and employment initiative run by a United States university, targeting foundational digital literacy for more than 50,000 learners, intermediate workforce credentials for 10,000 and advanced technical certifications for 2,500 in fields including artificial intelligence, cloud computing and project management, delivered through universities, refugee-serving organisations and more than 100 local facilitators	MOVEMENT
iPRIS regulatory capacity programme	Did not exist	A EUR 9.5m European Union programme running 2023 to 2028 to build regulatory capacity for inclusive, secure and competitive digital markets, operationalised at a regional conference on electronic-communications and postal regulation hosted by a national regulator; no participating-regulator count or output is published; its eighth cohort met at Nairobi from 5 to 9 October 2026, six national regulators with three regional regulators' associations, co-financed by Sweden, the European Union and Luxembourg	MOVEMENT
Pan-African media innovation programme	Did not exist	A six-week certified course for 42 journalists, editors and practitioners from ten countries, covering media innovation and entrepreneurship, digital transformation and platform economies, digital journalism and analytics, and media ethics and governance	MOVEMENT

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-10-01	AT 2026-10-12	PROGRESS
Her CyberTracks women's cybersecurity programme	BASELINE NOT HELD	Nearly 50 women cybersecurity professionals from across Africa gathered in Addis Ababa for the regional training, funded by Germany, the European Commission and Italy and co-implemented by the ITU and GIZ with the UNODC cybercrime programme	BASELINE NOT HELD
Leadership Excellence in Africa's Public Sector (LEAPS) programme	BASELINE NOT HELD	Running, implemented by the African Capacity Building Foundation with Gates Foundation support and aimed at leadership and governance capacity for public financial management reform; the foundation's position is that reform in Africa stalls on leadership gaps, institutional fragmentation and resistance to change rather than on policy	BASELINE NOT HELD
Regional training in digital land record systems	BASELINE NOT HELD	The regional mapping centre is training 55 government officials from its 20 member states on planning and managing digital land record systems: bringing surveying, registration, valuation and mapping into one system; connecting it to national mapping, valuation, urban planning and online public-service platforms so information is not re-entered; data accuracy, access control and protection against intrusion; and the choice between hosting state data in one place or another	BASELINE NOT HELD

Access to services

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-10-01	AT 2026-10-12	PROGRESS
Cotonou Declaration on digital transformation in West and Central Africa	Did not exist	Ministers committed to equipping persons with disabilities, alongside youth and women, with digital and entrepreneurial skills, and to creating two million digital-economy jobs benefiting those groups by 2028; the declaration sets out expected results, partnerships and financial commitments, governance and monitoring, and names no budget figure against the jobs target	MOVEMENT

Digital divides

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-10-01	AT 2026-10-12	PROGRESS
Smartphone shipments and entry-level affordability	Three consecutive years of shipment growth to the second quarter of 2025, with aggressive price reductions in that quarter	Shipments fell 7% year on year in the second quarter of 2026, the first decline in three years, with the sub-$100 segment down 34% - nearly three million units - and the average selling price up $41 to $202; the research house forecasts a 26% decline for 2026, memory now accounts for nearly 60% of the bill of materials for sub-$400 devices and over 64% under $99, and an entry-level handset can cost up to 73% of a low-income adult's monthly income in sub-Saharan Africa; the mobile industry association's 2026 connectivity report puts an entry-level internet-enabled handset at 76% of average monthly income for the poorest fifth in Sub-Saharan Africa at the end of 2025, against 44% across low- and middle-income countries, with memory prices more than doubling between the third quarter of 2025 and the first of 2026	REGRESSED
Gender gap in internet use	BASELINE NOT HELD	43 per cent of African men used the internet in 2024 against 31 per cent of women, a gap of twelve percentage points, on the regional economic commission's 2019-2024 series	BASELINE NOT HELD

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-10-01	AT 2026-10-12	PROGRESS
Women and girls digital-inclusion accelerator	BASELINE NOT HELD	An industry-body accelerator backed by two private foundations opened its next call for digital-inclusion solutions for women and girls across India and sub-Saharan Africa, with a grant amount listed at INR 42,000,000	BASELINE NOT HELD

The repository holds almost nothing continental on capacity, and the one item it does hold is an industry body's. A women and girls digital-inclusion accelerator opened, backed by two private foundations, with no baseline behind it and no cohort figure yet published.

That is the finding rather than an omission: skills and inclusion programmes are run nationally and appear on the country ledgers, so this section stays thin until a continental instrument exists to fill it. The pledges that do appear are made at continental level and delivered, if at all, somewhere else.

Finance

Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-10-01	AT 2026-10-12	PROGRESS
Share of the African Union's budget financed by its own members	About 22 to 25 per cent, a decade after the 2016 Kigali Decision	Unchanged on the newest figure held; the Union's 2025 programme budget was 77.5 per cent externally funded	NO CHANGE

MoUs and other agreements

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-10-01	AT 2026-10-12	PROGRESS
Afreximbank Academy and CreditRegistry financial-literacy memorandum	Did not exist	A three-year memorandum announced from Cairo on 25 August 2026 between the African Export-Import Bank's corporate academy and a credit-information company, integrating the latter's Africa Consumer Credit Academy curriculum into the academy's learning platform and covering digital financial literacy, credit education and trade capacity-building; it also undertakes to drive awareness and take-up of the bank's MANSA due-diligence repository and of PAPSS. A first initiative targets 20,000 to 30,000 learners, against a stated ambition of reaching about three million families and businesses	MOVEMENT
AUC-Google memorandum on AI	Did not exist	Signed on AI and cloud infrastructure, skills, research and AI policy, with a pledge to train three million students and teachers by 2030	MOVEMENT
AUC-ITU cooperation memorandum	Did not exist	Signed across AI, digital public infrastructure, skills, connectivity, cybersecurity, space technology and standards, naming the Commission the continental coordinating partner for the 55 member states. A further memorandum establishing a strategic framework for cooperation on the continent's digital transformation agenda was signed in Geneva on 7 September 2026 by Commissioner Lerato D. Mataboge and Secretary-General Doreen Bogdan-Martin.	MOVEMENT

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-10-01	AT 2026-10-12	PROGRESS
Five-year telecommunications and digital-infrastructure memorandum with an Indian technology company	Did not exist	A five-year memorandum of agreement between an Indian technology company, a continental investment council and an Ivorian mobile operator to develop telecommunications and digital public infrastructure across the continent, dated 2026-08-07 and fully executed on 2026-08-19 per a regulatory filing. It covers national fibre backbones, 4G and 5G, submarine cable landing stations, internet exchange points, telecom towers, and digital identity, national interoperability, e-government and digital payment platforms. No financial commitment is disclosed	MOVEMENT
K-AI Package	Did not exist	A South Korean offer tying AI solutions, AI data centres and power supply facilities to infrastructure projects financed by its Economic Development Cooperation Fund, set out to ministerial delegations from 45 African countries alongside a 2026 KOAFEC joint declaration, 13 new trust-fund projects across seven fields and a letter of intent to establish a Korea-Africa AI Hub at the African Development Bank	MOVEMENT
Korea Eximbank-AfDB cooperation on AI and digital financing	Did not exist	A pact signed in Seoul on 9 September 2026 by Korea Eximbank chairman Hwang Ki-yeon and continental development bank president Sidi Ould Tah, during the eighth Korea-Africa Economic Cooperation ministerial, under which the two institutions are to seek expanded joint financing for African projects in artificial intelligence, critical minerals and green infrastructure.	MOVEMENT
Proparco partnership with Yas and AXIAN Energy	Did not exist	A strategic partnership under which the French development finance institution may provide up to EUR 300m over three years for sustainable digital infrastructure and renewable-energy projects of a pan-African telecom group and its energy arm; no country allocation or first investment is published	MOVEMENT
ATU partnership with the UN Office for Digital and Emerging Technologies	BASELINE NOT HELD	A partnership between the African Telecommunications Union and the UN digital office on artificial-intelligence capacity building and digital public infrastructure, reported as supporting secure open-source architectures for identification, payments and regional data exchange; no text, budget or named deliverable is published	BASELINE NOT HELD
ECA-DHL memorandum on SME cross-border trade	BASELINE NOT HELD	A non-exclusive memorandum for an initial three years between the UN Economic Commission for Africa and DHL Express Sub-Saharan Africa, delivered through DHL's GoTrade programme, covering capacity building for women- and youth-owned businesses, digital trade, research and knowledge sharing; the first engagement is a virtual training series on customs, logistics, e-commerce, digital trade and trade finance. No budget is stated	BASELINE NOT HELD
Korea-Africa AI Hub	BASELINE NOT HELD	A letter of intent between the continental development bank and the Republic of Korea to establish a hub supporting the responsible development, adoption and financing of artificial intelligence across the continent, signed on the sidelines of the eighth Korea-Africa ministerial. It is a letter of intent and not an agreement: no capitalisation, host, governance or start date is published, and the bank separately puts AI's potential at up to US$1tn of African GDP by 2035	BASELINE NOT HELD

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-10-01	AT 2026-10-12	PROGRESS
Smart Africa-Kitsoft memorandum on public-sector digital transformation	BASELINE NOT HELD	The Smart Africa Secretariat and Kitsoft, a GovTech company with Ukrainian roots, signed a memorandum covering digital public infrastructure, e-governance and AI: exchange of practice, joint expert and training sessions, and building public services on Kitsoft's low-code Liquio platform, whose community edition can be self-hosted. No signing date, value or country deployment is stated	BASELINE NOT HELD

New investments

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-10-01	AT 2026-10-12	PROGRESS
AfDB-AXIAN digital finance programme for women-led businesses	Provided for within a US$160m African Development Bank senior corporate loan to AXIAN Telecom approved on 31 January 2025, of which over US$10m was earmarked for 22,000 women entrepreneurs in Madagascar through the Mvola platform and a US$2.5m grant for financial literacy and credit access for 34,000 women-led businesses in Madagascar, Tanzania and Senegal; nothing launched	Launched to reach more than 34,000 women-led enterprises in five African countries through the AXIAN Group's Mixx and Mvola digital financial services platforms, combining digital lending, financial literacy training and business development services, with support from the African Development Bank's Affirmative Finance Action for Women in Africa initiative and the Women Entrepreneurs Finance Initiative	MOVEMENT
Africa50 Infrastructure Acceleration Fund	A US$222.5m first close of December 2023, with the Development Bank of Southern Africa and Axian signing to invest in December 2024; no second close stated (2024-12)	Fourth close of about US$330m, joined by British International Investment's US$20m commitment alongside the African Development Bank, the International Finance Corporation and more than 20 African institutional investors; the fund, managed by Africa Infrastructure Investment Partners, directs capital to logistics, power, water and sanitation and social infrastructure as well as digital connectivity; the size and date of the second and third closes are not established	MOVEMENT
African technology equity and debt funding	US$3.25bn in total equity and debt funding across 534 deals in 2024	US$4.1bn in 2025, up about 25% year on year and the strongest level since 2022, across 570 deals, up 7%; debt reached its highest volume ever at US$1.6bn, up 63% on a 40% rise in the number of debt transactions and making up almost half of total capital raised, while equity funding grew 8% on a broadly stable deal count, so the growth came through larger ticket sizes rather than more transactions	MOVEMENT
AI 10 Billion Initiative	Did not exist	Launched, with a ten-month partnership roadshow to follow	MOVEMENT
BIASHARA 2063 project (AU Commission institutional systems)	US$50m of IDA financing approved on 1 June 2023 to build the AU Commission's and AfCFTA Secretariat's capacity, not yet effective at the first status report and closing 30 June 2028 (2023-09)	A World Bank-financed programme building the Commission's own institutions and systems, procuring wireless infrastructure for its headquarters; no results framework or disbursement figure held	MOVEMENT

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-10-01	AT 2026-10-12	PROGRESS
Boost Ventures in Africa	Did not exist; its predecessor Boost Africa fully deployed since January 2024	A European Investment Bank successor to Boost Africa, backed by a EUR129m European Commission guarantee covering all its fund investments, with technical assistance for fund managers and portfolio start-ups funded initially at EUR4.5m from EFSD+	MOVEMENT
Cassava Technologies equity raise	US$90m of equity from two development financiers and a hyperscaler (2024-12)	A chip designer joined an investor roster of eleven, amount undisclosed (2025-10); more than US$150m of fresh equity announced for the fibre subsidiary's debt refinancing, including that stake, a minority stake in the data-centre subsidiary taken by a South African asset manager and a rights offer (2025-11)	MOVEMENT
Development agency shift from aid delivery to investment mobilisation	Did not exist	A United Nations development agency told its executive board that its finance model is shifting from delivering aid to using scarce public resources to unlock investment at scale, citing official development assistance down 23.3% in 2025 with a further fall expected	MOVEMENT
Digital Africa Seed Fund	Did not exist	A closed-end seed-stage fund with a ten-year horizon, sized at EUR 30m with a hard cap of EUR 50m, targeting 30 startups across 20 priority African countries at an average first ticket of EUR 300,000, and positioned as the seed step between the sponsor's pre-seed vehicle and institutional Series A investors	MOVEMENT
Digitalisation of cooperative agricultural financial institutions	Did not exist	EUR 12,000,000 committed by a bilateral development ministry to digitalise cooperative agricultural financial institutions in West Africa	MOVEMENT
Foundation call for AI in family planning	Did not exist	A private foundation opened a call for proposals using artificial intelligence to widen access to digital contraception information across sub-Saharan Africa, offering up to US$500,000 a project, with applications closing on 25 August 2026	MOVEMENT
Hewlett Foundation grant to BudgIT (general operating support)	Did not exist	US$1,000,000 committed (US$500,000 disbursed) as general operating support to BudgIT's budget-transparency and civic-tech work	MOVEMENT
Hewlett Foundation grant to BudgIT (learning systems and communications)	Did not exist	US$50,000 committed and fully disbursed to strengthen BudgIT's learning systems and strategic communications	MOVEMENT
Hewlett Foundation grant to Cenfri (digital transformation programme)	Did not exist	US$300,000 committed (US$150,000 disbursed) to renew Cenfri's work on digital transformation and its link to evidence-informed policymaking across Africa	MOVEMENT
Hewlett Foundation grant to Data4Change (Data Hub: Africa)	Did not exist	US$400,000 committed (US$200,000 disbursed) to Data4Change's Africa Hub, building community-generated evidence for policy and practice in East and West Africa	MOVEMENT
Hewlett Foundation grant to ICED (AI-enabled evidence generation)	Did not exist	US$100,000 committed and fully disbursed for the International Centre for Evaluation and Development to adopt AI-enabled evidence generation institution-wide	MOVEMENT
IFC equity investment in Jumia	Did not exist	US$25m of IFC equity inside a wider US$50m raise	MOVEMENT
IFC sustainability-linked loan to WIOCC (WIOCC VI)	Did not exist	Up to US$20.4m equivalent in a US dollar and a rand tranche, approved 5 December 2025, signed 10 December 2025 and invested 14 May 2026	MOVEMENT
Investment in a carrier-neutral digital infrastructure platform	Did not exist	a shareholder subscription agreement signed in Riyadh for a combined US$300m investment from a continental infrastructure financier and a Saudi investment company, the largest capital raise in the platform's history	MOVEMENT

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-10-01	AT 2026-10-12	PROGRESS
Liquid Intelligent Technologies debt refinancing	A US$620m bond due September 2026 and a ZAR term loan outstanding	US$660m of debt closed: a US$300m Eurobond oversubscribed 2.5 times with development-finance anchor orders, a US$210m ZAR term loan and a US$150m USD term loan, alongside US$195m of fresh equity from the parent; the US$620m bond and the ZAR term loan retired	MOVEMENT
Mergers and acquisitions in the digital economy	68 deals across the whole of 2025	84 deals worth an estimated US$11.4bn in disclosed value between 1 January and 17 August 2026	MOVEMENT
Saviu II venture capital fund	Did not exist	A continental development bank committed EUR 6.5m - EUR 4.5m as equity and a EUR 2m first-loss tranche on behalf of the European Commission under its Boost Africa programme - to a seed-stage technology fund that is to place at least 60% of commitments in Francophone West and Central Africa, investing EUR 500,000 to EUR 3m in about twenty start-ups	MOVEMENT
Share of funded African tech startups led by a female chief executive	17 of 178 funded ventures, 9.6%, taking 7.9% of the capital (2025)	5 of 60, 8.3%, taking 2.8% of the capital (2026 to May)	REGRESSED
TaxDev III (IFS tax and social-protection policy data programme)	Did not exist	Institute for Fiscal Studies programme, funded by the UK's FCDO, building tax and social-protection policy data resources and tools with finance ministries and revenue authorities in Ethiopia, Ghana, Kenya, Nigeria, Rwanda and Uganda; about US$6.36m disbursed 2023-2026	MOVEMENT
United States development finance equity in a pan-African digital infrastructure operator	Did not exist	Equity of up to US$155m against total project costs of up to US$450m, approved by the agency's board on 16 September 2026 and described by the operator as the agency's largest single equity investment; the agency was added on 21 September to the US$300m round signed on 1 September by a continental infrastructure financier and a Saudi investment company, and its participation is stated to be subject to further steps before commitment and closing, including congressional notification	MOVEMENT
Wind-down of a blockchain backer of African startups	An operating blockchain with a fund and accelerator pipeline backing African early-stage companies	The Swiss operator said on 25 August 2026 that it will discontinue its blockchain on 31 October 2026 and wind down its governance organisation, ending a funding and accelerator pipeline that had backed African companies in Nigeria, South Africa and Rwanda; it cited chain revenue insufficient to support its token, proposes burning 100 million tokens to cut supply from 400 million to 300 million, and has arranged a migration path for projects onto another chain. African blockchain startups raised US$90.1m in 2025, down 26.6% on the year	CLOSED
World Bank Group Digital and AI Implementation Plan FY26-30	Did not exist	Approved by the Board on 24 June 2026 and disclosed on 20 August 2026, committing the group to 600 million people using broadband internet and 400 million using digitally enabled services by 2030 through four pillars and ten solutions that task team leaders and investment officers are required to embed across projects, initially in 40 priority countries of which 19 are African	MOVEMENT
Boost Africa	Fully deployed in January 2024 across six venture-capital funds; EUR88m invested by the end of 2023, stated to have mobilised close to EUR400m and supported 15,000 jobs	EUR108m invested through the EU and European Investment Bank initiative across Africa, stated to have attracted about EUR400m more and supported up to 15,000 jobs	NO CHANGE fully deployed since January 2024

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-10-01	AT 2026-10-12	PROGRESS
EU Multiannual Indicative Programme for Sub-Saharan Africa 2021-2027	EUR 490m for priority area 4, Digital and Science, Technology and Innovation, of which EUR 240m for digital transformation, within a regional envelope of EUR 12,000m	Unchanged; the mid-term review cut priority area 4 from EUR 1,240m to EUR 490m and its digital transformation component from EUR 940m to EUR 240m, or 2.0 per cent of an envelope enlarged from EUR 10,242m to EUR 12,000m, and no later amendment is held	NO CHANGE
MIGA political-risk guarantee on Raxio data centres	In force, 15-year term from 2022	Up to US$11.01m for 15 years on an infrastructure investor's stake in data centres in Uganda, Mozambique and Côte d'Ivoire	NO CHANGE
United Kingdom Digital Development Strategy 2024-2030	Published March 2024 with four 2030 targets: halve the connectivity gap in 20 countries, support digital public infrastructure in 20, back eight African AI labs and bring 50m women online	The same four targets still published, against a Global Tech directorate allocation of £24m, £22m and £24m for 2026/27 to 2028/29 and an analyst's finding that no published funding stands behind the strategy itself	NO CHANGE the targets stand on a small technology line
Africa Finance Corporation digital bond	BASELINE NOT HELD	CHF 350m raised on a five-year digital bond listed, traded and settled on a regulated digital exchange — stated as the first by an African institution — priced at a 1.4925% coupon and arranged by two European banks; it is the issuer's fourth and largest Swiss franc issuance	BASELINE NOT HELD
African share of a European development group's digital portfolio	EUR193.5m, 67.3% of the group's digital commitments over 2021-2023, a commitment flow rather than a standing portfolio (2024-11)	EUR 558m, 59% of the group's standing digital portfolio of about EUR 948m and its largest region by a wide margin, against EUR 293m newly committed group-wide across 47 projects in 2025 and 152 projects in execution in 57 countries and territories (2025, published 2026-08-28)	BASELINE NOT HELD the earlier figure is a three-year commitment flow and not comparable with the portfolio
Capital raised by startups from a technology company's African accelerators	Over US$300m raised since 2018 by 153 startups from 17 countries in the company's Accelerator Africa programme alone, with more than 3,500 jobs created (2025-06)	More than US$1bn raised cumulatively since 2017, with a stated survival rate above 90% against a 70-80% failure rate for the wider ecosystem (2026-08)	BASELINE NOT HELD the earlier figure covers one programme and not the company's accelerators together
Development-finance and infrastructure-fund partnership	BASELINE NOT HELD	A British development finance institution and a continental infrastructure fund announced a strengthened partnership to scale infrastructure financing across Africa, connectivity among the named sectors; no commitment amount, fund vehicle, country allocation or timetable is published	BASELINE NOT HELD
Eastern Africa Regional Statistics Program-for-Results	BASELINE NOT HELD	US$321m committed by the World Bank in 2022 for Kenya, Rwanda, Tanzania, the East African Community and the African Union, US$155.5m disbursed, active to 2027	BASELINE NOT HELD
FSD Africa-funded startup acquisition programme	BASELINE NOT HELD	The UK aid-funded agency is funding the consultancy S2E Africa to find corporate acquirers for African startups, assess targets and build in-house deal capability, with Pula among its first three clients; it takes no stake in the acquisitions. No budget is stated	BASELINE NOT HELD
Growth-capital investment in a pan-African messaging infrastructure provider	BASELINE NOT HELD	US$12m into a provider of application-to-person messaging — one-time passwords, transaction alerts and delivery updates — operating across 35 African countries through 15 operator partnerships	BASELINE NOT HELD
Harmonizing and Improving Statistics in West Africa project	BASELINE NOT HELD	US$413.8m committed by the World Bank in 2020 for Burkina Faso, Cabo Verde, Cote d'Ivoire, Ghana, Liberia, Togo, the African Union and the West African community, US$375.0m disbursed, active to 2026	BASELINE NOT HELD

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-10-01	AT 2026-10-12	PROGRESS
Harmonizing and Improving Statistics in West and Central Africa, first series	BASELINE NOT HELD	US$464m committed by the World Bank in 2023 to improve statistical performance, regional harmonisation and data access in participating countries, US$202.0m disbursed, active to 2028	BASELINE NOT HELD
Harmonizing and Improving Statistics in West and Central Africa, second series	BASELINE NOT HELD	US$440m committed by the World Bank in 2023 to improve statistical performance, harmonisation and modernisation of national and regional statistical systems, US$169.9m disbursed, active to 2029	BASELINE NOT HELD
KOICA Youth Leadership Programme	BASELINE NOT HELD	US$34m stated by Korea for a programme coupling public governance and policy development with artificial-intelligence-driven digital government, hosted by the Ghana Institute of Management and Public Administration for 200 participants from Ghana, Nigeria, Cote d'Ivoire, Senegal and Cameroon, in three phases - online training, in-country sessions, and a funded 14-day study visit to Korea for the best performers	BASELINE NOT HELD
Limited-partner commitments to African private-capital funds	BASELINE NOT HELD	64 commitments in the second quarter of 2026 against 53 a year earlier, with disclosed value of US$272m against US$847m in the same quarter of 2025 and US$1.18bn in the first quarter of 2026; no disclosed commitment above US$50m, and information technology appeared in 61% of commitments against 17% a year earlier	BASELINE NOT HELD
LINGUA Africa language-model grants	BASELINE NOT HELD	26 projects covering more than 50 African languages, dialects and sign languages across 47 countries, each awardee eligible for up to US$250,000 in cash and US$400,000 in compute credits; health, agriculture and justice are the stated use cases	BASELINE NOT HELD
SADC Regional Statistics Project	BASELINE NOT HELD	US$171.5m committed by the World Bank in 2023 for Madagascar, Mozambique, Malawi, Zambia, Comoros, Sao Tome and Principe and the southern African community's secretariat, US$80.0m disbursed, active to 2028	BASELINE NOT HELD
Sloane Capital startup and MSME fund and the KUMii matching platform	BASELINE NOT HELD	22 On Sloane launched KUMii, an AI platform matching startups to funders, tenders and mentoring with more than 4,000 startups and MSMEs registered, and its licensed lending arm opened a R1 billion raise, reported as about US$63m, to finance startups and MSMEs across Africa; nothing is stated as raised	BASELINE NOT HELD
Stage mix of a development financier's African portfolio	BASELINE NOT HELD	79% of one development financier's African deals are at Series B or later, so it operates less like a venture fund than a later-stage investor	BASELINE NOT HELD

Private digital-infrastructure operators refinanced and raised capital. Liquid Intelligent Technologies closed US$660m of debt in April 2026, including a US$300m Eurobond oversubscribed 2.5 times, and retired its US$620m bond due September 2026; its parent announced more than US$150m of fresh equity in November 2025. An IFC sustainability-linked loan of up to US$20.4m to WIOCC was invested on 14 May 2026, a continental financier and a Saudi investment company signed US$300m into the same operator on 1 September, and the United States development finance agency's board approved US$155m of equity on 16 September, subject to congressional notification before commitment.

Official development assistance fell 23.3% in 2025, with a further fall expected. Against the continental AI strategy, governments are reported to have committed about US$150m of public capital.

Where the record is thin

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Ratifications and domestication of the AfCFTA Protocol on Digital Trade	The AfCFTA Secretariat's or the depositary's ratification list, against the threshold the Protocol sets for entry into force; probed 2026-08-05: no depositary list located, but published legal analyses state the threshold is 22 state parties and that it has not been met, and name Nigeria as the first to approve ratification; located, not fetched	2026-08-05
Member-state implementation status of the AU Data Policy Framework	A Commission report on domestication by member state; probed 2026-08-05: no status report located, but the Commission held a validation workshop at Addis Ababa on 1-4 December 2025 on three draft continental frameworks — data categorisation and sharing, cross-border data flows, and an open data strategy — which the repository does not hold at all; located, not fetched	2026-08-05
Budget of the African Union's own digital programme	A budget line for the Information Society division or the Digital Transformation Strategy, as against the Union's headline budget; probed 2026-08-05: the 2026 budget totals and the programme-budget split are published in secondary analyses, with no digital line disaggregated in anything located	2026-08-05

What the repository cannot state at continental level is mostly the effect of what it can. There is no ratification count for the digital trade protocol, no budget for the union's own digital programme, no continental measure of workload concentration on foreign cloud, and no delivery figure against any of the training pledges made this year — a fifth memorandum signed in August adds three million learners to the pledged total and no method of counting them.

The pattern is consistent enough to name: continental instruments are adopted and announced in public, and their implementation is reported nationally or not at all. A reader wanting to know whether any of this reached a person has to go to the country reports, and for several of these instruments those reports are silent too.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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